# 埃里克
# Erick

## 目录 / Contents


前夜 / The Night Before . . . . . 2
教鞭与木剑 / Pointy Stick and Wooden Sword . . . . . 6
夺宝历险记 / The Adventures . . . . . 15
长梦将尽 / The End of a Sweet Dream . . . . . 18
假故事 / A Fake Story . . . . . 23
天真之诗 / The Song of Innocence . . . . . 29
梦醒时分 / Awakening Hours . . . . . 37
跃往明日 / A Leap Into the Future . . . . . 41

# 前夜
## The Night Before AGD-01

After the Good Dream
美梦后记

The Night Before
前夜

Do not love half lovers
Do not entertain half friends
Do not indulge in works of the half talented
Do not live half a life and do not die a half death

— Kahlil Gibran, "Half is not Enough"
不笃爱，那些投身一半的爱人。
不博取，那些托予一半的友谊。
不沉溺，那些止于一半的文化。
若死，便不苟延残喘；若生，便就酣畅淋漓。

——纪伯伦·哈利勒·纪伯伦《半而未满》

The "Great" Storyteller: You've certainly heard your fair share of stories. From the bedtime tales your mom told you to the bragging from kids at school...
“伟大”讲述者：要我说，你肯定听过不少故事。从你妈妈给你讲的睡前故事，到学校里那些小孩子的自吹自擂——

The "Great" Storyteller: Or, or... like those smooth talkers you occasionally encounter in taverns.
“伟大”讲述者：或者、或者……就是你知道，酒馆里也偶尔会蹦出的几个能说会道的家伙。

The "Great" Storyteller: Stories in the classroom, on benches where pigeons are fed, on TV and in comic books... you've heard plenty, and most of them are cliché.
“伟大”讲述者：教室的故事会、喂鸽子的长椅、电视、漫画书……你听得够多了，而且它们大多老掉了牙。

The "Great" Storyteller: But hear me out, I’m sure you’ve never heard a story as astonishing and legendary as this one!
“伟大”讲述者：但听我说，你绝对、绝对没有听过这样令人惊异、传奇的故事！

The "Great" Storyteller: It's more thrilling than the surging waves of the sea—a story that a bard could captivate a tavern full of drunks with, every one of them forgetting their drinks.
“伟大”讲述者：汹涌的海涛不如它惊心动魄，吟游诗人靠它就能让那群酒鬼听得忘乎所以，放下酒杯。

The "Great" Storyteller: And you. You will be honored as its very first listener!
“伟大”讲述者：而你，将荣耀地成为它的第一位听众！

The room is silent, the chaos outside blocked by the suitcase. Not even a thousand woodpeckers could peck open this door—
房间内一声不响，喧嚣被挡在箱外，一万只啄木鸟也敲不开这扇门——

"Bang—!"
“哐当——！”

The door bursts open.
大门被闯开了。

Sonetto: Timekeeper, now's the time, put the arm ring on her!
十四行诗：司辰，趁现在把她的臂环套上去！

Sonetto pins the girl to the ground and winds back her head, preparing to deliver a dizzying headbutt.
十四行诗把女孩摁倒在地，对方使劲儿努起头，准备给她一记眼冒金星的头槌。

???: You bunch of sneak-attacking thieves! Harald will come looking, and then he'll throw you all... into the sea to feed the fish!
???: 你们这帮偷袭的贼家伙！哈拉尔会找过来，然后把你们都……丢进海里喂鱼！

Vertin: ...
维尔汀: ……

???: What—what are you doing!?
???: 你，你们要干什么?!

Vertin: Erick, we need you to calm down.
维尔汀: 埃里克，我们需要你冷静一些。

The arm ring settles in its familiar resting place, grasping her slender yet firm arm.
抓起硬朗却瘦小的臂膀，臂环回到了它的老地方。

They bind her with rope and place her in a chair.
绳子捆缚住双手，她像一只被捆住的螃蟹，被摆到椅子上。

Erick: Let—me go!
埃里克: 放——开我！

Erick: You damn kidnappers, eat my foot!
埃里克: 你们这些该死的绑匪，吃、吃我一脚！

The girl's feet, unable to touch the ground, jab wildly at her two captors.
女孩够不着地面的双脚，直挺挺地往两人戳去。

But like a puppy on a leash, her target is just out of reach.
但就像拴了绳的小狗，目标始终遥不可及。

Sonetto: Sorry, it was my miscalculation... I thought a 12-year-old Arcanist would be gentler and more... controllable.
十四行诗: 抱歉，是我预估的失误……我本以为一位 12 岁的神秘学家，会更加温和以及……可控。

Vertin: No one could have anticipated this.
维尔汀: 这是我们都难以预料的。

Sonetto: Yes. Next time, I'll consider using Arcane Skills.
十四行诗: 是的。下次我会将神秘学能力也列入考量因素里。

The "Great" Storyteller: At this moment, our protagonist, a brave and clever captive, watches quietly. She narrows her eyes, trying to determine the origin of her two assailants.
“伟大”讲述者: 此刻，我们的主角——英勇、聪慧的俘虏不动声色，眯着眼睛开始揣测这两名偷袭者的来历。

Erick: Huh? Ah, I've seen that emblem before. So you're from that What's-it-called Foundation!
埃里克: 嗯？啊～我见过那个图案，原来你们是从那个叫什么基金会来的家伙！

Sonetto: You know about us!
十四行诗: 你知道我们！

Erick: Hmph, of course. I have eyes and ears everywhere.
埃里克: 哼哼，当然～你们身边可到处都是我的耳目。

Erick: Anyway, neither of you will pry a word out of me! Even if you pull out my teeth one by one without any anesthetic, it's impossible!
埃里克: 总之呢，你们谁都别想撬开我的嘴！就，就算你们拿不打麻药的拔牙钳也不可能！

Erick proudly raises her head, as if her hands are akimbo on her hips rather than bound behind her back.
埃里克得意地昂起头，仿佛背后那双手没被捆住，而是叉在腰上。

Sonetto: I've seen your family's records. Your mother's side has lived in Sogn Fjord for generations.
十四行诗：我看过你们家族的资料，你妈妈的家族世世代代生活在松娜峡湾。

Sonetto: She's an extraordinary woman. The Norwegian branch of the St. Pavlov Foundation has received a lot of help from her.
十四行诗：她是位了不起的女性，圣洛夫基金会挪威分部曾受过她许多帮助。

Sonetto: But ever since she...
十四行诗：但自从她……

Erick: Quite well-informed, aren't you, long-ears?
埃里克：消息很灵通嘛，你这个长耳朵的家伙。

Erick: If she hadn't sailed off for that incredible treasure, you would never have caught me!
埃里克：要不是她为了无与伦比的宝藏远航，你们才抓不住我～

Vertin: Sonetto...
维尔汀：十四行诗……

Vertin gives a subtle shake of the head.
橘发少女察觉到了旁侧轻轻摇晃的头。

Sonetto: ...I understand.
十四行诗：……我明白了。

Sonetto: Anyway, you're living with your grandfather and father now, right?
十四行诗：总之，你现在跟你的外祖父和爸爸生活在一起，对吗?

Vertin: We mean you no harm. Just, considering your father's and grandfather's status as Arcanists, we would like to offer you as much help as possible.
维尔汀：我们没有恶意，只是基于你与你的外祖父神秘学家身份的考量，希望尽可能为你们提供帮助。

Sonetto: We have a unique school filled with kids like you—extraordinary ones. I think you'd be interested.
十四行诗：我们有一所与众不同的学校，里面都是你这样……了不起的孩子。我想你会感兴趣的。

Erick: But I'm already in school—I mean, I already have a school within my territory!
埃里克：我已经在上学校了——我是说，我已经有一座学校作为领地了！

Erick: I have a crew of sailors there, ready to plunder everything here at my signal!
埃里克：在那里，我已经有了好多名水手，只要我一声令下，就能把这地方的东西劫掠个精光！

Vertin: But our school is unique. It's full of territories yet unclaimed.
维尔汀：但那个地方不一样。里面有很多还没有归属的领地。

Sonetto: Yes, and a bunch of kids—sailors—yearning for a jarl to lead them.
十四行诗：是的，以及一群渴望领主的孩——水手。

Erick: Oh... that does sound tempting. More interesting than the tedium of Stillwater Lake School anyway...
埃里克：喔……那确实很诱人，比静水湖小学解闷多了！

Erick: But I need to speak to my crew. Not for their approval, of course! Just so they don't panic without me.
埃里克：可是，我得跟他们说一声。当然，不是为了征集同意！只是不能让他们失去我后手忙脚乱。

Erick: You know, they're lost without someone at the helm—
埃里克：要知道，他们可是没了一个掌舵的人——

Vertin: We've already gotten Harald's consent, Erick.
维尔汀：我们已经征询了哈拉尔的同意，埃里克。

Erick: But...
埃里克：可是……

A small wooden scabbard lies on the table, along with a letter.
一柄小小的木制剑套摆在桌上，还有一封小小的信。

Vertin: This is what he left for you.
维尔汀：这是他留给你的。

Erick, her hands freed, picks up the letter from the table.
解开双手的束缚，埃里克拿起了桌上小小的信。

Letter: "Erick, you're about to venture into a place full of dangers. It will be daunting and fearsome."
信件：埃里克，你即将去往一个危机四伏、险象丛生、让人望而生畏的地方。

Letter: "Every warrior of Valhalla must face such a challenge before adulthood; you will endure many hardships and a long, long time without us."
信件：每个英灵殿战士在成年前都会遇上这样一次挑战，你得忍受困难，以及一段很长、很长没有我们的日子。

Letter: "But I believe you'll make new friendships and return triumphant with countless treasures."
信件：但我相信你会收获新的友谊，并携带着无数财宝凯旋。

Letter: "When the time comes, your father and I will throw a night-long feast for you, with unlimited soda and popcorn of every flavor."
信件：到时候，你爸爸和我，会为你设一场不眠的宴席，我会让他提供喝不完的汽水、满屋子的爆米花——什么味道的都有。

Letter: "Note: You can trust these two; they're good people."
信件：注：你可以相信那两个家伙，她们人还算不错。

Letter: "--Yours forever, Harald."
信件：——你永远的哈拉尔。

Erick: Oh... okay, I thought I'd get a proper chance to say goodbye to everyone.
埃里克：噢……好吧，我还以为能跟大家好好告一次别呢。

Erick: Jason "the Slob's" workbook is still at my place, and there are two raid allowances I haven't used this month...
埃里克："邋遢鬼"乔森的作业本还放在我家里，这个月还有 2 次劫掠的次数没花完呢……

She sulks, cupping her cheeks, elbows on the table, her face puffed up like a blowfish.
她闷闷不乐地捧着脸颊，双肘撑在桌子上，脸像一只鼓起的河豚。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

# 教鞭与木剑
## Pointy Stick and Wooden Sword AGD-02

Pointy Stick and Wooden Sword
教鞭与木剑

One month later
1 个月后

School of Primary Defense of Mankind
第一防线学校

Students swarm to the end of the hallway, gazing up at the little jarl on the stairs.
学生鱼涌般聚集在走廊尽头，瞻望着楼梯上的号令者。

Student I: Hey, don't push me!
学生 Ⅰ：嘿，别挤我！

Student II: Who stepped on my shoe!?
学生 Ⅱ：谁把我的鞋子踩下去了！

Student III: Shh, shush! Quiet down!
学生 Ⅲ：嘘、嘘嘘！别吵！

Erick: ...In any case, as your jarl, I promise you fame, fortune, and... extra snacks!
埃里克：……总而言之，作为领主，我保证你们会获得应有的名利与……额外的零食配给！

Erick: Row those oars like never before, sailors! Just like the mysterious adventurers of old!
埃里克：去把桨划得冒烟，水手们！像以前那名神秘的冒险者一样！

The crowd cheers in unison.
白色的小袍子们齐齐雀跃地欢呼。

Golden Key Sancho: You're going to get caught by the instructors... then you'll be locked in a dark room all day without any food. Breaking school rules is such a dumb idea.
金钥匙桑丘：你们会被教员抓起来的……然后关进黑漆漆的小房子里，饿上一整天。
违反校规可是最愚蠢的行为。

His sharp voice pierces the excited atmosphere.
声音尖锐地戳破了兴奋的气氛。

The excitement dissipates, and the little ones in robes start whispering, their eyes all focused on him.
聚集的兴奋被一扫而空，小袍子们开始交头接耳，目光齐刷刷地聚焦到他身上。

Golden Key Sancho: This is so unrealistic. I suggest you spend more time preparing for the next test. The students who score lowest will have to take extra classes to make up for it.
金钥匙桑丘：这一点儿也不切实际，我劝你们不如多花花时间准备下一场测验，最后几名可是要进行强制补习的。

Golden Key Sancho: Most importantly, if you do poorly in Arcane Skills, you'll probably end up as janitors after graduation.
金钥匙桑丘：最重要的是，如果你们神秘术测验很差劲，最后毕业时，大概就会成为打扫卫生的职员。

Golden Key Sancho: Sitting in a lonely office with a musty smell you can't get rid of...
金钥匙桑丘：坐在无人问津的办公室，身上从来都是一股发霉的味道……

Children's minds are always so vividly imaginative.
对世界的想象，总是取代现实，充盈孩子们的脑海。

Golden Key Sancho: Hmph, and I'll become the brightest star at the LSCC.
金钥匙桑丘：哼哼，而我则会成为拉普拉斯科算中心最闪耀的明日之星。

Golden Key Sancho: You'd better start thinking more practically, like me...
金钥匙桑丘：你们呀，最好像我这样务实一点……

Erick: Are you kidding!? I've known many cowards like you before...
埃里克：什么！你这样的胆小鬼我见得多了。

Golden Key Sancho: Hmph, who's the coward? At least I don't need others to do my bidding.
金钥匙桑丘：哼，到底谁才是胆小鬼？我可用不着找别人来帮我做事。

Erick: You...!
埃里克：你这个家伙……！

Erick's face turns red with anger.
Just as she's about to storm over—
她涨红了脸，气不打一处来。
而正当她气冲冲地走过去——

A hand grabs her.
一只手却拉住了她。

Effie: For the peace and welfare of mankind! What you're doing is completely pointless.
埃菲：为了人类的和平与福祉，要我说，你们在做的事全没有任何意义。

Like weather vanes, the crowd turn their heads to this new interloper.
小袍子们的头像风向标，又齐齐挪向了另一个人。

Student I: It's Dreary Eifer! Run!
学生 I：是丧气鬼埃菲！
快跑！

Student II: Ugh, she's going to put me off my lunch...
学生 II：诶呀，我可不想连午饭也吃不下……

The little robes scatter, leaving the three of them standing alone.
小袍子们一哄而散，只留下三根光杆。

Erick: Hey, don't go! Our plan isn't even—
埃里克：嘿，别走！
我们的计划还没——

Effie: Your plan is meaningless, regardless of whether you fail or succeed. In the end, you'll either face endless anxiety or insatiable emptiness.
埃菲：计划也没有意义，不管你是失败还是成功。
最后，你都只会迎来惶惶不可终日或者永远填不饱的空虚。

The girl with the dim eyes points at the retreating crowd.
眼神黯淡的女孩指着人群的背影。

Effie: Even if you assemble them time and again, they'll still walk away in the end.
埃菲：……即便你一次次召集了他们，也没有什么能阻止他们最终走开。

Golden Key Sancho: Not true! Some people are meant for more! And the others...
金钥匙桑丘：才不是！有的人注定更有意义！
而剩下的那些……

Erick: Agh... so annoying! Both of you, just shut up!
埃里克：啊——烦死了！
你们两个快给我闭嘴！

She storms over, kicking up a cloud of dust with each step.
她气呼呼地冲上去，脚下每踏一步都仿佛有一阵滚滚烟尘。

A battle for glory is inevitable.
一场关乎荣耀的战斗在所难免。

The three scuffle, pushing and shoving, but none yields to the others.
三人扭打在一起，推搡着，像三只互不服气的螃蟹。

The school bell rings. They freeze momentarily. Then, they scatter like kittens and race back to the classroom.
上课铃响起，三人愣住一阵。
接着他们齐齐发射出去，小猫般抢着对方的尾巴，跑回了教室。

Instructor: ...As for the glavakus, they are a kind of critter that primarily inhabits the tropical rainforests of North America.
教员：……至于“格拉瓦库斯”，它是栖息于北美洲热带雨林中的一种魔精。

Instructor: Being omnivorous, they are an adaptable species with a remarkable ability to form colonies even in the most extreme conditions.
教员：作为杂食性魔精，它们具有丰富的物种多样性，能在各种极端条件下生存并发展成群落。

Instructor: Please turn to page 126 of “The Compendium of Critters.”
教员：请翻至《魔精通识》126 页。

Instructor: As you can see, studies show that their colonies operate under a distinct hierarchy.
教员：你们可以看到，研究调查显示它们的种群文化里有鲜明的上下级关系。

Instructor: The stronger the scent of a glavakus, the higher its status. They rely on their acute sense of smell and sensitive hearing, for they lack vision.
教员：身上气味越浓重的格拉瓦库斯，种群地位便越高。
它们没有视觉，只依靠敏锐的气味与声音感知周遭的一切。

Instructor: From our last class, how should you react when encountering such creatures?
教员：一如我们上堂课所讲述的，如果遇到这种危险生物应该怎么办?

Students: Do not run or jump; walk quietly!
众学生：不跑不跳，轻声走！

During the students' unified chant, a slight discord can be heard.
在学生们整齐、统一的声潮下，只有最敏锐的耳朵才能听见其中潜藏的异响。

Erick: Pfft, pfft...
埃里克：噗呲、噗呲……

Golden Key Sancho & Effie: ？
金钥匙桑丘&埃菲：？

Erick: You two... have truly impressed me. I challenge you to a duel!
埃里克：你们两个家伙……确实让我刮目相看。
——我要对你们发起征服决斗。

Erick: The loser will bow to the winner and become their faithful sailor!
埃里克：失败者就要向胜者俯首，成为忠实的水手！

Erick’s assertive voice pierces the chorus, and the instructor frowns.
她高昂的声音从声潮中冒出尖儿，教员皱起眉头。

Instructor: Erick, you seem to have some... unique opinions.
教员：埃里克，你似乎有一些……与众不同的意见?

Instructor: Stand up and share them.
教员：站起来，说说你的看法。

Erick: W-What?
埃里克：什，什么？

She stands up hastily. The blackboard reads, “Large, Dangerous Critters.”
她慌忙地站起来。
黑板上的标题写着“庞大、危险的魔精生物”。

Erick: Um...
埃里克：唔……

Clearly, our hero's attention was never on the instructor.
Scratching her cheek, she tries to recall any relevant information.
显然，我们的英雄注意力从没有在教员身上停留。
她挠着脸颊，试图从小小的脑袋里揪出任何有关的记忆。

Erick: Well, my grandfather Harald once said...
埃里克：关于这个，我的外公哈拉尔说过……

She looks up at the frowning instructor. The classroom falls silent. All eyes are on her.
她抬起头，注视着皱眉的教员。
教室一片肃静，所有人都盯着这位起立者。

Erick: He said, “In life, one must defeat many things, like super-heavy cars or giant brown bears. But the most dangerous of all...
埃里克：他说：人这一生，总要遇到并打败很多东西，可以是重得不行的汽车，可以是超大号的棕熊，但是其中最最最危险的——

Erick: “Is the endless Vanity and boundless Emptiness.”
埃里克：是无止境的虚荣，以及一望无际的虚无。

The instructor's eyes flicker with confusion, but she listens intently.
教员的眼睛闪过疑惑，却仍仔细地听着。

Erick: The monster known as “Vanity” is a huge, winding snake, as large as a mountain range! It opens its mouth, bottomless, and swallows anyone who strays into it.
埃里克：名为“虚荣”的怪物，是一只山脉般巨大、蜿蜒的巨蛇！
它张开嘴巴，里面深不见底，好多迷路的家伙走失进去，再也没从里面出来过。

Erick: It swallows them whole, then spits out the bones in piles a mountain high!
埃里克：它吃东西从来不嚼，可却能吐出山那么高的骨头！

The students gaze unblinkingly, hearts lodged in their throats.
学生们目不转睛，心都提到了嗓子眼儿。

Erick: The monster known as “Emptiness” is a cunning, deceitful creature. One that no one has ever truly seen...!
埃里克：而叫作“虚无”的怪物呢，是一只狡猾、诡计多端的家伙，从来没有人真正见过它！

Erick: It lurks in the shadows. At night, the noises under the bed, the flash outside the window, the drips in the bathroom—any one of them could be it!
埃里克：它躲在阴影底下。夜晚，床底下的响动、窗外一闪而过的东西、厕所里响起的滴水声——全都可能是它！

Erick: Sometimes, it's right next to your ear; at others, it’s far, far away.
埃里克：有时它会贴得你耳朵那么近——有时，它又会离得很远很远。

Erick: It stalks grown-ups, not with a gaping jaw but with claws as sharp as potato wedges...
埃里克：它喜欢跟在那些大人身后，它没有血盆大口，但却有像薯角一样尖锐的爪子……

Erick: It silently approaches those drowning in sadness, regret, and despair. When they cover their faces, too overwhelmed to be wary, it extends its bloodied claws...
埃里克：它会偷偷绕到那些沉浸在悲伤、悔意、绝望里的人身后，当他们掩面的时候，根本无暇警惕背后，它便会伸出血淋淋的爪子……

Erick: Shwoop!
埃里克：嘶哈！

The students shudder in unison.
学生们不约而同一震。

Erick: To finish off those poor souls!
埃里克：把那些可怜人了结！

Erick: In my view, these are the largest and most deadly of critters.
埃里克：在我看来，它们就是最庞大，也是最致命的魔精生物。

Erick: Of course, I've never met these terrible beasts. Harald says I'm not tall enough yet. But one day, one day, I will.
埃里克：但当然，我还没有遇见过这两只可怕的怪物。哈拉尔说我还长得不够高。但总有一天，总有一天，我会遇到它们的。

Erick: I'll knock them down and beat them so hard they can't even stand up straight!
埃里克：我会把它们打趴下，揍得它们在陆地上都站不稳！

The students' eyes sparkle with admiration, and they quickly break into applause.
学生们的眼睛炯炯有神，瞩目着这位骄傲的领主，紧接着掌声如潮。

Even her opponents, Sancho and Eifer, can't help but get lost in thought.
即便是那两位对手，也不免陷入沉思。

Golden Key Sancho: ...
金钥匙桑丘：……

Effie: ...
埃菲：……

The instructor sighs. This student will be a bone to chew for sure.
教员叹一口气，她咬上了一块硬骨头。

Instructor: Erick, a fitting critter ought to be...
教员：埃里克，符合条件的魔精应该是……

The ring of the school bell cuts her off. Class is dismissed.
下课铃准时响起。

The students swarm, flocking towards Erick.
学生们前赴后继，朝着埃里克簇拥而上。

Instructor: Erick, come to my office later.
教员：埃里克，稍后来办公室一趟……

In the bustling crowd, Erick raises her hand and waves.
涌动的人潮中心，一只小手举起来，挥舞着。

Erick: Yes, ma'am!
埃里克：好的，女士！

...
……

Students' hostel
学校宿舍

The night casts its shadows on Erick's youthful cheeks. She breathes softly.
夜晚铺盖在稚嫩的脸颊上，伴着轻轻的鼻息。

She lies on her bed, underneath which sits "The History of Potions." She twirls her pen in her hand.
她趴在床上，底下垫着《魔药历史》，手上的笔不停打转。

After a moment, she stops, buries her head in the paper before her, and begins to write.
片刻，她仿佛确定了什么，埋头在信纸上写起来。

Erick: "Dear Harald—"
埃里克：“致亲爱的哈拉尔——”

Erick: "This is my first winter at the SPDM."
埃里克：“这是我在第一防线学校呆的第一个冬季。”

Erick: "I've met many new sailors here, each boasting their own impressive tricks."
埃里克：“我在这里认识了好多新的水手，他们每个人都有自己厉害的绝活。”

Erick: "One can make saplings sprout out of stones; another can fly with the wind; there's even one who can foresee test questions!"
埃里克：“能让石头长出嫩芽的家伙，可以乘着风飞起来的家伙，还有能预言测试题目的……”

Erick: "My fleet has grown much larger, and there are many places here that I can't wait to explore."
埃里克：“我的船队壮大得多了，这个地方还有很多等待我去冒险的地方。”

Erick: "I will unearth all the treasures I can here, hide them in my drawer, and give some of them to you when you come to pick me up."
埃里克：“我会把这里的宝藏都挖出来，藏到我的小抽屉里，到时候等你来接我了，就分给你一些～”

She looks up, glancing at the book on the desk, her brows furrowed.
她仰起头，瞥了眼桌子上的书，小小的眉头皱起来。

Erick: "But the instructors here are mean. They're always frowning, and they like locking students up in the guardhouse."
埃里克：“但这里的老师可不好说话，他们凶巴巴的，总是紧皱着眉头，喜欢把人关禁闭室里。”

Erick: "Today, I spoke of the monsters 'Vanity' and 'Emptiness' in class."
埃里克：“今天，我在课上说了‘贪婪’和‘虚无’那两头怪物。”

Erick: "The instructor called me to the office and said, 'Those are not considered monsters.' — Can you believe it!?"
埃里克：“她把我喊去办公室，说：‘那两头算不上怪物。’——瞧瞧这话！”

Erick: "Then she rambled on about the history of critter surveys and made me memorize it all."
埃里克：“又说什么根据魔精调查的历史，巴拉巴拉一大堆东西，让我背下来。”

Erick: "In terms of boredom, these instructors are all the same!"
埃里克：“在无聊这方面，这些老师们倒是一个样！”

Erick: "Of course, my sailor crewmates support me. They said those were the scariest monsters they'd ever heard of, a hundred times more dangerous than anything in the 'Critter Dictionary!' When I walked out of the office, wow—"
埃里克：“当然，我的船员水手们倒是都挺我，他们说那是他们听过最恐怖的怪物，比《魔精词典》上的都要危险一百倍！等我从办公室走出来，哇噢——”

Erick: "They surrounded me, chanting 'Erick', 'Erick', 'Erick'! I'd never seen such a large and enthusiastic crew!"
埃里克：“他们把我簇拥起来，高喊‘埃里克’、‘埃里克’、‘埃里克’！我从没有见过那么多船员！”

Erick: "I talked to them from school dismissal till evening. By the end of it, I could hardly feel my tongue!"
埃里克：“我从放学一直给他们讲到傍晚，舌头都要着火啦！”

Erick: "...But I really miss you, Harald."
埃里克：“……可我真想念你，哈拉尔。”

She stretches out her hand and rubs her eye.
她伸出小手，揉了揉眼。

Erick: "When I walked out of the office, for a brief moment, I was expecting to see you standing by the door. Once I'm done with this adventure, be sure to come pick me up in old John's beat-up car."
埃里克：“当我走出办公室，有那么一阵，我还以为你会站在门口呢。等我完成这次冒险，你一定要记得开着老约翰那辆破车来接我。”

The sound of footsteps echoes from under the door.
门缝底下，一阵错落的脚步声缓缓接近。

???: Pfft, pfft!
???：噗呲、噗呲！

Erick: Oh, right on time...
埃里克：噢，来得真准时……

Erick: "Tonight's duel challengers are here; I have to go.
"Please say hi to old John and his beat-up car for me."
埃里克：“今晚征服决斗的两个家伙到了，我要先走了。
“请替我向老约翰和他那辆破车问好。”

Erick: "—Your brave and fearless Erick."
埃里克：“——你勇敢无畏的埃里克。”

She folds the letter, slipping it into an envelope.
她小心翼翼对折信纸，放进信封。

Then puts it carefully under her pillow, like a treasure.
接着，宛若宝物一般藏到了枕头下。

George the Oak
乔治橡树

Erick: Huff, huff, huff...
埃里克：哈、哈、哈……呼。

Erick pants, hands on the ground, beads of sweat dripping from her golden hair and onto her forehead.
她气喘吁吁，双手趴在地上，额头上汗水黏满金发。

Sancho and Eifer are standing upright, unflinching.
而另外两人直直站着，面不改色。

Golden Key Sancho: I thought you were something special... Can't even perform a decent Arcane Skill! Your test scores must be terrible.
金钥匙桑丘：我还以为你有多了不起……
连个像样的神秘术都不会，你的测验成绩肯定很差劲。

Effie: ...Go back to sleep, dueling her is pointless, she's no chance of beating us.
埃菲：……回去睡觉吧，跟她决斗没有任何意义，她不可能赢我们的。

Erick: Not true! If I could take off this arm ring, you two would be running scared!
埃里克：才，才没有！要是我的臂环能摘下来，你们两个都得屁滚尿流！

Golden Key Sancho: Yeah, right, you people always have excuses –– stomach ache, hungry, rainy weather...
金钥匙桑丘：算了吧，你们这种人总有各种各样的借口，肚子疼、没吃饱、下雨天……

Golden Key Sancho: Always concocting a reason for your failures, then making another grand promise before the end of the week!
金钥匙桑丘：心安理得地接受自己的各种失败，没过多久，又信誓旦旦地夸下另一个海口。

Effie: It's like running in circles. More pointless than playing catch with a ball...
埃菲：就像在同一个地方兜圈子，比接抛球还没意义……

Footsteps and dim lights approach from the dark road yonder.
漆黑静谧的道路远方，传来脚步与隐隐的光亮。

???: Hey, you shouldn't be out here. What are you doing!?
???：嘿，现在可是休息时间。
你们在干什么！

Golden Key Sancho: !!!
金钥匙桑丘：！！！

Golden Key Sancho: Oh no, it's the school disciplinary witch... Run!
金钥匙桑丘：糟糕，是学校的纪律女巫……快跑！

But by now, the figure is standing right in front of them. She grabs Eifer and Sancho by their collars.
说话间，远方的身影已经站在身前，抓住了两只小白袍的后领子。

Matilda: Hah! As the SPDM's disciplinary assistant, leaving without permission—
玛蒂尔达：哈！作为第一防线学校的纪律辅员，你们擅自离开——

Matilda: Oh, ow!
玛蒂尔达：噢，疼！

Sancho bites the witch's left arm, giving him a moment to escape her grasp.
她的左手留下发红的齿痕，一只小白袍从手里逃走了。

The "Great" Storyteller: Erick lunges at her other arm...
“伟大”讲述者：而我们伟大的英雄此时又扑向另一只手臂……

The witch shakes her arm, releasing Eifer, and then—
这位纪律辅员迅速甩开手臂，放开了埃菲，转而——

Matilda: Hmph! Caught you!
You know it's past curfew...
玛蒂尔达：哼哼！抓住你了！
你们要知道，现在可是在宵禁时间……

Erick is pinned to the ground, as if weighed down by a pile of stones.
埃里克被一把摁倒在地，身上如负重石。

Erick: Now's your chance. Run, you idiots!
埃里克：趁现在，快跑，你们两个笨家伙！

The two snap out of it and run into the darkness.
两人如梦初醒，撒开腿跑向远方。

The "Great" Storyteller: They look back, catching a glimpse of our hero's brave resistance.
“伟大”讲述者：他们不时回头，望见我们的英雄不卑不亢地抗争。

The "Great" Storyteller: Until their vision is obscured by the night's mist...
“伟大”讲述者：直到视线被夜晚的薄雾所遮蔽……

It didn't take long for punishment to arrive.
惩罚来得并没有太晚。

The corridor is empty and silent. Having been punished, Erick stands alone by the classroom door. Her stomach growls.
走廊已空无一人，四处没有喧嚣，她形单影只，被罚站在教室门口，肚子咕咕叫唤。

She glances at her shoes, idly picks her nose, and stares out the window at the dimming twilight. The orange afterglow has reached her knees.
瞧瞧鞋底，抠抠鼻子，无所事事地望向窗外，昏黄的余晖已经淌到了膝盖上。

There's a sudden rustling sound from around the corner.
阴影的拐角，忽然传来悉悉索索的声响。

Erick: A jarl never ever gets scared! Come out now! I mean— you'd better show yourself, or else...
埃里克：领主可、可可是从不会害怕！
你快出来——我是说，最好给我乖乖现身，不、不然……

From the corner of the hallway, two little heads pop out like rabbits.
走廊尽头，两个小脑袋像兔子一样从拐角冒出来。

Golden Key Sancho: Are you okay?
金钥匙桑丘：你还好吗?

Erick's bravely puffed chest finally deflates.
为了壮胆而挺起的胸膛，终于塌了下去。

Golden Key Sancho: I snuck you some fried cod... You must be starving.
金钥匙桑丘：我兜里偷偷藏了些炸鳕鱼……你肯定饿坏了。

She grabs the offered meal, devouring it like a bear starved through the winter.
她一把抓住递过来的炸鳕鱼，狼吞虎咽起来，像是饿了一整个冬季的熊。

Effie: ...Why did you help us?
埃菲：……你为什么要帮我们?

Erick: (Munching) Because I can't let my future crew fall into another's hands. It was nothing, really. Being a jarl means more than just giving orders; you have to take on responsibility too.
埃里克：嚼嚼～因为我可不能让未来的船员栽在别人手里。
这不算什么，作为领主，除了发号施令，还有很多要承担的责任。

Erick: Even the most powerful of jarls will eventually fall from grace if they avoid their personal responsibilities and simply order others around.
埃里克：就算是名声远扬的领主，如果只知道使唤别人和逃避责任，最后也都会毁于一旦。

Golden Key Sancho & Effie: ...Wow!
埃菲&金钥匙桑丘：……哇!

Erick: I heard that in ancient times, there was a king who ruled over the biggest forest in the world...
埃里克：我听说远古时期，曾经有一个君主占领着全世界最大的森林……

Listening intently, Sancho and Eifer gradually lower themselves to the floor until they are fully seated, utterly mesmerized by her vivid storytelling.
他们静静听着，逐渐蹲坐下来，瞩望着她绘声绘色地描述那些神奇的事迹。

From the fading rays of the twilight sun to the silvery glow of moonlight, night gracefully arrives.
从流淌的昏黄，再到铺洒而下的银白，夜晚悄然赶来。

Their eyes glow brightly. They swallow hard, absorbing the tales of greatness, wonder, and the incredible.
而他们的眼眸始终熠熠生辉，喉咙吞咽口水，咽下关于伟大、离奇、匪夷所思的一切。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

# 夺宝历险记
## The Adventures AGD-03

The Adventures
夺宝历险记

Letter: “Dear Harald—”
信纸：亲爱的哈拉尔——

Letter: “Grown-ups often say that torches will extinguish, great trees will wither, and even the endless feasts will eventually end in a great mess.”
信纸：大人们常说，火炬会熄灭，巨树会枯萎，就连彻夜不眠的盛宴，也迟早只会留下一片杯盘狼藉。

Letter: "'Heroes too will have their curtain call,' they say earnestly, solemnly, unwilling to move even for the remote control that they're sitting on."
信纸：“英雄也总会有落幕的时候”，他们一本正经，煞有介事，屁股压住遥控器都不肯挪一下。

Letter: “Grown-ups act like they know everything, issuing commands like they're kings and queens. But what do they know, really?”
信纸：大人摆出一副什么都懂的样子，像一位君王对孩子发号施令，可实际上呢?

Letter: “Maybe they've only sneaked a peek at the door to glory and pride.”
信纸：他们可能也只不过是在那扇，通往荣誉与骄傲的门扉前，偷偷瞥过一眼。

Letter: “They say, 'don't climb too high.'”
信纸：他们说——别爬太高。

Matilda: Get down from that tree right now, you rascals. Or else... I'll make you fall!
玛蒂尔达：你们这些家伙，快给我从树上下来。
不然，我就要……让你们摔跟头了！

Erick: We're not coming down until we catch that Huma bird! I'm sure it'll appear at dusk.
埃里克：在抓住那个“呼玛鸟”之前，我们绝不会下来！
等到了黄昏，它一定会出现的。

Golden Key Sancho: It's said that if you feed them toenails and smelly boots for three days, they'll grant you a wish. I'll make them eat all the test papers so we won't have any more exams!
金钥匙桑丘：据说只要喂它们吃泡了 3 天的臭皮靴和脚趾甲，就能获得一个愿望。我要让它们吃掉所有的试卷，这样我们就不用考试了。

Effie: I—I want it to find the book the instructor threw away.
埃菲：我，我要让它找到被教员丢掉的书。

Matilda: Damn, you little troublemakers. I'm coming up!
玛蒂尔达：可恶，你们这帮小捣蛋鬼。
我要爬上去了！

Erick: No, no, don't! This tree can't take anymore— Ah—!
埃里克：不不，别上来！这棵树不能再——
啊——！

Golden Key Sancho & Effie: Ahh—!
埃菲＆金钥匙桑丘：啊——！

Letter: “They say, ‘don't think too much.’”
信纸：他们说——别想太多。

Erick: ...Will the ghost really come? I'm getting sleepy.
埃里克：……真的会有幽灵过来吗？我已经有点儿发困了。

Effie: It will, I’m sure of it! They say that the ghost of that missing student appears here on the night of every full moon...
埃菲：一定会有的！他们说，那个失踪学生的鬼魂，在每个满月的夜晚，就会出现在这里……

Golden Key Sancho: And if we find him, he’ll reveal the exam questions for next week!
金钥匙桑丘：而只要找到他，就能知道下次考试的题目！

Erick: Okay, well, I’m going to lay down and sleep for a bit until he—
埃里克：好吧，我先趴在地上睡会儿，等他——

Golden Key Sancho: (Patter, patter) Look!
The ghost is here.
金钥匙桑丘：噗呲噗呲，瞧！
“幽灵”来了。

Matilda: The moon is just perfect tonight...♫
Hum-dee-dum, now to take out my orbuculum.
玛蒂尔达：今天的月亮正好～♫
哼哼，接下来拿出我的占卜水晶球。

Matilda: Huh? Who's there!
玛蒂尔达：嗯？是谁在那儿！

Erick: Ahh—!
Run!
埃里克：啊——！
快走！

Letter: “They say, ‘don't run too fast.’”
信纸：他们说——别跑太快。

Instructor: In this lesson, you will learn how to deal with a glavakus.
Now, I will release a domestically bred...
教员：在这堂课中，你们将会学到如何应对“格拉瓦库斯”。
接下来我将放出人工圈养的……

Erick: Ahhhh— My cloak!
Sailors, stop it!
埃里克：啊啊啊——我的披风！
船员们，快点帮我把它给拦住！

Glawackus: Roaaar!
格拉瓦库斯：嗷嗷嗷！

Golden Key Sancho: Jarl, quick! Stop now—!
金钥匙桑丘：领主，快停下来——！

Effie: It follows loud, fast-moving things—!
埃菲：它喜欢响声大，跑得快的——东西！

Erick: I can't—hear—you!
埃里克：我听——不——见！

Letter: "Don't climb too high, don't think too much, don't run too fast, don't be too selfish, don't wander too far, don't go... on adventures!"
信纸：“别爬太高，别想太多，别跑太快，别太自我，别走太远，别去……冒险！”

Letter: “If we listened to these grown-ups, all those amazing treasures, great feats, and countless heroic tales would end up like the remote control under their butts: lost in the couch forever!”
信纸：要是都听这些大人的话，那些珍奇的财宝，那些了不起的壮举，那些数不胜数的英雄事迹，都该像他们屁股底下的遥控器，掉进任谁都找不见的沙发缝里了！

Letter: “So, my dear Harald—I've gathered a crew of SPDM students with extraordinary abilities to lead a rebellion against all these boring grown-ups.”
信纸：所以，亲爱的哈拉尔——在第一防线学校，我召集了一帮能力出众的船员，一起反抗那些无聊的大人。

Letter: “They are loyal and dedicated to me.”
”They have remained unflinching; even in the face of the nasty witch.”
信纸：他们忠心耿耿，为我鞠躬尽瘁。
面对凶狠的女巫，面不改色。

Golden Key Sancho: I swear, it was me who ate the fish and chips. I ate it all on my own!
金钥匙桑丘：我发誓，是我一个人把所有的炸鱼薯条都偷来吃了！

Matilda: ...
玛蒂尔达：……

Effie: (Patter, patter) Jarl, the corner of your mouth...
埃菲：噗呲、噗呲……领主，你的嘴角。

Erick: Oh!
埃里克：噢！

Letter: “They possess the wisdom of Mimir and the agility of Thor.”
”Even the craftiest of witches are helpless against them.”
信纸：他们拥有密米尔的智慧、索尔的机敏。
最狡猾的女巫对此也束手无策。

Matilda: Hey, what's that bulging in your pocket?
玛蒂尔达：嘿，你口袋里鼓起来的是什么?

Erick: It's, uh, it's...
埃里克：呃，是、是……

Effie: —It's the stinky, chewy chunk I gave her!
埃菲：——是我送给她的熏臭嚼嚼块！

Effie: You wouldn't want to fish it out with your hand. It'll make you so sick that you won't be able to eat the whole night long!
埃菲：你不会想用手掏出来的，她会让你恶心得一整晚都吃不下饭！

Matilda: Sniff, sniff...
玛蒂尔达：嗅、嗅……

Letter: “Even in the most critical moments—”
信纸：即便在千钧一发之际——

Golden Key Sancho: Hey—hey! Isn't that Miss Sonetto?
金钥匙桑丘：嘿——嘿！那不是十四行诗女士吗?

Matilda: Hmm? What?! P-Perhaps she needs the help of an outstanding disciplinary assistant!
玛蒂尔达：嗯？什，什么?！她，她或许正需要一名优秀的纪律辅员的帮助！

Matilda: I-I'll be right back!
玛蒂尔达：我，我待会儿就回来！

Letter: My crew and I always find a way out.
信纸：我和我的船员也总能逃出生天。

Erick: "I have to say, my heart is bursting with excitement!"
埃里克：“不得不说，我的心激动得都要蹦出来啦！”

Erick: "My dear Harald, I can't wait to show you everything I've achieved here."
埃里克：“亲爱的哈拉尔，我已经等不及让你看到我在这里荣获的一切。”

Erick: "Also, how is my crew at Stillwater Lake doing? Did Dumb Howard take over the park? Did Old John find the note I stuck on the bumper of his car? Ha-ha-ha, he must have been furious..."
埃里克：“另外，我在静水湖的船员们都还好吗？‘蠢牛霍华德’有没有把公园的空地抢走？老约翰发现我贴在他车屁股后边的纸条了吗？哈哈哈，他肯定气得够呛……”

Erick: "Also, I got the chewing gum you sent. My crew absolutely loves it."
埃里克：“还有，我收到了你送来的嚼嚼糖，我的船员们可是爱死它了。”

Erick: "Also, how come your handwriting looks so much neater? Is Aunt Sigrid from next door writing your letters for you?"
埃里克：“另外，你的字怎么比之前看起来好了那么多？是邻居的西格莉德阿姨在替你写信吗?”

Erick: "Hah, she's got you all figured out!"
埃里克：“哈，你果然被她给迷糊住了！”

Erick: "Anyway, I hope everything is well with you."
埃里克：“总之，希望你在那边一切都好。”

Erick: "Well, I'm off to sleep! This 'Introduction to Alchemy' book is as heavy as a rock and gives me a headache."
埃里克：“那么，我先睡啦！那本像石头一样重的《炼金术概论》，把我弄得头晕脑胀。”

Erick: "—Missing you, Erick."
埃里克：“——想你的埃里克。”

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

# 长梦将尽
## The End of a Sweet Dream AGD-04

The End of a Sweet Dream
长梦将尽

"The children, soaring over sleepy houses and the sparkling sea, finally reach the dreamy island."
“孩子们，飞过酣睡的房屋，与璀璨的海，终于抵达了梦幻的那处岛。”

"The tide loves them so much it rolls itself into a blanket to welcome them."
“海潮多么喜爱他们，把自己卷成了毯子，为他们迎接。”

"The fairies gather around, plucking waves and stars to crown them."
“仙子们围绕着他们，也把浪花与星星摘下，为他们冠冕。”

"The joyous children climb the highest cliffs above the sea."
“徜徉在欢悦中的孩子们，爬上了最高的海角。”

"But don't get too comfortable, and don't let your guard down."
“可别松心，也别太惬意。”

"Children. When dusk falls upon the island, you'll know it's coming."
“孩子们。当小岛一片黑暗的时候，你就知道它要来了。”

Curfew holds no sway over these nimble little feet.
宵禁，总是难以束缚那些灵活的小脚丫。

Three shadows tiptoe by the silent lakeshore. Even the smallest cough would shatter the stillness in the air.
三个小影子蹑手蹑脚，寂静的湖边，哪怕一声咳嗽都会撞碎空气。

But the silence can only last so long, and despite their best efforts to keep quiet, a voice slips out.
而沉默太久，即便他们竭力堵住了嗓子，一个声音还是悄悄溜了出来。

Golden Key Sancho: Say, do you think that critter will really take us as its masters?
金钥匙桑丘： 我说，那只魔精真的会把我们当主人吗?

Golden Key Sancho: Strange... It dug a hole there under its butt, put the can of food inside, then spat on it.
金钥匙桑丘： 呃……它把我们好不容易省下来的午餐罐头都挖坑埋在屁股底下，又啐了一口唾沫。

Golden Key Sancho: Boss, maybe we should try something else...
金钥匙桑丘： 头儿，或许我们该换个法子……

Effie: Sancho, how does your knowledge of critters suck so much? The instructor literally explained this morning that glavakus use their spit to distinguish food from trash.
埃菲： 桑丘，还记得你的魔精通识为什么那么差劲吗？教员今天早上明明刚说过，那是格拉瓦库斯的生存习惯，它们用唾沫区分食物与垃圾。

Erick: Right, right. The instructors may be boring, but they do spout some wisdom.
埃里克： 没错，我的好船员。教员虽然无聊透顶，但他们嘴里还是能冒出不少智慧。

Erick: One day, this big boy will willingly serve us and be our obedient mount!
埃里克： 总有一天，这个大家伙会对我们心悦诚服，乖乖做我们的坐骑！

Erick: Also, there's a saying. How does it go? “When God locks the door, he leaves a window open through which we may slip out.”
埃里克： 而且有句话……怎么说来着？上帝那小子把你的门锁住了，可别忘记还有一扇窗让你溜出去。

Effie: Uh, Jarl, I don’t think that’s—
埃菲： 呃，领主，这句话似乎——

Golden Key Sancho: Hey, duck down! Duck down! The witch is coming again!
金钥匙桑丘： 嘿，把头低下！把头低下！恐怖女巫又来了！

Effie: Don't step on my foot! Gah! I literally just polished these shoes tonight!
埃菲： 别踩我！噢！我今晚才刚擦的鞋子！

Erick: Shush! She's coming!
埃里克： 嘘嘘！她过来了！

Their hands meet their faces as they huddle together.
手脸相抵，他们挤成一团。

The witch hurries past. She pauses at a critter cage on the other side of the room.
一个身影匆匆走过，在远处的魔精笼边驻留了脚步。

Matilda: "Oh... glavakus Number 15, why do you have diarrhea again?! I've been feeding you exactly according to the 'Critter Feeding Manual'..."
玛蒂尔达： 噢……格拉瓦库斯 15 号，你怎么又拉肚子了！
我明明好好按照着《魔精饲养指南》喂食……

Matilda: Someone else must be feeding you...
玛蒂尔达：看来，一定是有谁在偷偷给你喂食……

Glawackus: *Brrrr*...
格拉瓦库斯：呜呃……

The poor creature, unable to speak, curls up in distress.
可怜的小家伙苦于言语不通，委屈地蜷成了一团。

Dejected, the three unreliable "masters" sneak away.
三个不可靠的“主人”，灰溜溜地逃走了。

As the night deepens, they return to the dormitory.
夜色变深，他们终于回到了宿舍附近。

Effie: Ugh, I have to go to class all sweaty again tomorrow...
埃菲：呜，明天又要一身臭汗去上课了……

Golden Key Sancho: Ha-ha-ha, you smell just like that critter! Maybe it'll even take you as its leader.
金钥匙桑丘：哈哈哈哈，要我说，你现在闻起来跟魔精一个样，说不定，它还会把你当头儿呢。

Eifer's face turns red. She pinches his arm hard.
埃菲涨红了脸，用力掐住他的臂膀。

Effie: Hmph! I'll put a curse on you to be thrown out of school tonight! Not even the instructors can protect you then!
埃菲：哼！我回去就马上诅咒你被丢到学校外边儿去！那样就连教员也保护不了你了！

Effie: You'll be like a soap bubble floating in the sewer!
埃菲：就像冲进下水道的肥皂泡一样！

Golden Key Sancho: Hey, Eifer, don't...
金钥匙桑丘：嘿，埃菲，别……

Sancho suddenly turns solemn. He shakes his head, signaling her to stop.
桑丘的脸忽然冷下来，他摇了摇头，示意她别再说了。

Golden Key Sancho: ...Boss's family.
金钥匙桑丘：……头儿的家人。

The jarl's smile fades, and worry fills her eyes.
领主的嘴角不再上扬，眼睛里满是担忧。

Eifer immediately feels guilty.
这下轮到埃菲内疚了。

Effie: Sorry, Erick, I was just saying.
埃菲：抱歉，埃里克，我只是就那么一说。

Effie: Your dad and grandpa must be—
埃菲：你爸爸和外公肯定——

Erick: Duck! Hide behind the wall!
埃里克：把头趴下，躲到墙后边！

Erick clasps her hands over their mouths, instantly muffling their voices.
埃里克的手像两道闸门，堵住声音的洪口。

A suspicious looking figure lurks by a red postbox nearby.
远处的红色邮筒旁，一个身影正鬼鬼祟祟地徘徊。

Erick: Looks like someone's up to no good with our mailbox...
埃里克：看来，有家伙在打我们邮筒的坏主意……

Golden Key Sancho: Ewww... Boss, why does your hand smell weird?
金钥匙桑丘：呕哟……我说头儿，你的手怎么有股怪味儿。

Erick: Oh, sorry, I patted the glavakus's butt earlier.
埃里克：噢，抱歉，这只手刚刚拍过格拉瓦库斯的屁股。

She quickly lowers her hand, shaking it as if doing so could rid the stink.
她连忙把手放下来，甩了甩，像是这样就能把臭味儿给摆脱掉。

Effie: Ginger hair, checkered headband... hey, isn't that the distinguished alumna, Sonetto?!
埃菲：橙子颜色的头发，还有格子头带……嘿，那不是我们的优秀毕业生，十四行诗小姐吗?!

Effie: Oh... her hair is so pretty! Much prettier than my sister's. When I graduate, I want to dye mine the color of the leaves in autumn.
埃菲：噢……她的头发真漂亮，比我姐姐的漂亮多了。等我毕业，说什么也要染成那样像秋天一样的头发。

Golden Key Sancho: Isn't she the one who was top of the class in Potion Studies, Basic Arcanism, and Critter Training a few years ago?! Move your head, I want to see too!
金钥匙桑丘：就是那个，多年蝉联魔药学、基础神秘术、魔精驯养学……好多项成绩第一的家伙吗?！把你的头挪开，我也、我也要看！

Erick: Nothing to fuss over, crew. She may be great, but she's just one of my former opponents. For a bard, she's—
埃里克：没什么大惊小怪的，船员们。她再怎么厉害，但也只是我曾经的一名手下败将，
尽管她作为吟游诗人来说——

Effie: Strange, is she mailing something? But these aren't the non-student mailboxes...
埃菲：奇怪，她是准备寄东西吗？可非学员的邮筒不在这儿呀。

Golden Key Sancho: Look, she's stuffing a letter in there. But that's... that's...!
金钥匙桑丘：瞧，她把一封信塞进去了。
可那是……那是……！

Erick: !!!
埃里克：！！！

Having completed the task, the Sonetto hurries away.
远处的身影，在完成任务后，急急忙忙离去了。

As silence returns under the night sky, Erick dashes to her mailbox, pulling out the letter.
待寂静又重回夜幕，埃里克跑向自己的信箱，掏出那封热乎乎的信。

...
……

"To Erick..." The sender had falsely signed "...Harald" at the bottom.
“致埃里克”。
寄信人处假模假式地写着——“哈拉尔”。

Golden Key Sancho: Boss, why did you run so fast... Oh, is this a gift from Sonetto?! I thought everyone's mail was delivered by the postman during the day...
金钥匙桑丘：头儿，你怎么跑得这么快……噢，这是她给你的礼物吗?！我以为大伙儿的信，都统一白天由投递员寄送呢……

Golden Key Sancho: Hey, Boss...?
金钥匙桑丘：嘿，头儿……?

Sonetto: Don't worry, during the term, Harald will still... send you letters every month. The school postman is very punctual.
十四行诗：请不用担心，在校期间，哈拉尔每个月……仍会寄信给你。学校的投递员总是很准时。

Sonetto: You can write to him too; your communication will be unhindered...
十四行诗：你同样可以写信给他，你们的沟通同样会畅通无阻……

Vertin: We promised him that we would ensure your safety at school.
维尔汀：我们跟他保证过，要让你在学校安然无恙地生活。

Vertin: He trusts you can handle this. I'm certain you will.
维尔汀：他肯定一样相信你能做到这些。

...
……

"You can trust these two, they're good people. —Yours forever, Harald."
“你可以相信那两个家伙，她们人还算不错。——你永远的哈拉尔。”

Erick: Have they been lying?
埃里克：可如果，她们在撒谎呢?

Erick: Besides the first, all the letters were...
埃里克：除了那一封以外，所有的信都是……

Erick: If it's all a lie, then what's the point of all this?
埃里克：如果这一切只是谎言，事到如今，这一切都是为了什么?

Erick: The treasure, territories, crew... what's the point of my ambitions?
埃里克：那些所谓的财宝、领地、船员……那些不得了的雄心壮志，还有什么存在的意义?

Golden Key Sancho: Hey, Boss?
金钥匙桑丘：喂，头儿?

Golden Key Sancho: ...Ever since you got that letter yesterday, you've been acting a bit strange.
金钥匙桑丘：……从昨天拿到信之后，你就一直不太对劲儿。

Effie: Erick... Erick!
埃菲：埃里克，埃里克!

Erick: Oh... sorry, what were you saying?
埃里克：噢……抱、抱歉，你们在说什么?

Effie: What's wrong?
埃菲：你怎么了?

Erick: N-Nothing, just leave me be.
埃里克：没、没事儿，别管我。

Her gaze becomes vacant again, as if all this weren't real.
她的眼神又呆滞了，仿佛身边的这一切并不真实。

Steady footsteps approach from a distance.
稳练、循序的脚步声从远至近。

The students watch the advancing figure, lips firmly sealed.
学员们望着走过来的身影，无不紧闭嘴唇。

Instructor: Erick, there is a suspicion that you snuck off to the critter shed by the lake yesterday and fed the critters there. As I'm sure you're aware, this is against the school rules.
教员：埃里克，有人怀疑你昨天偷偷跑去湖边的魔精棚，违规喂食魔精。

Instructor: As of right now, there's no second witness to prove it was you. But, if it was you...
教员：现在暂时没有第二个目击者证明这是你的作为，但如果你……

Eifer stands up.
小小的身影站了起来。

Effie: Sh-She was with us the whole time yesterday, I can testify!
埃菲：她、她昨天一直跟我们待在一起，我可以作证！

Golden Key Sancho: I can too!
金钥匙桑丘：我也可以作证！

Erick: It was me.
埃里克：是我做的。

Erick stands up, arms dropping to her sides...
她站起来，松开了手……

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

# 假故事
## A Fake Story AGD-05

A Fake Story
假故事

Instructor: We accepted you as per the 'SPDM Listen-in Student Regulations,' giving you the opportunity to study alongside top scoring students.
教员：根据《第一防线学校旁听生条例》，我们接收了你，让你有机会和最高年级的学生一同学习。

Her eyes are as sharp as an eagle's.
她的眼睛如鹰喙般锐利。

Instructor: Otherwise, under the existing school rules, a student your age would be turned away.
教员：否则，按照我们既有的校规，像你这么大的学生，通常会被我们拒之门外。

Instructor: A lack of formal Arcanist education is only one factor...
教员：未曾接受正规的神秘学教育只是微不足道的一方面……

Instructor: After all, instilling technical and theoretical knowledge is of no difficulty to us.
教员：教授技术、理论性知识对我们来说，并不是难事。

Instructor: But noble character, respect for order, and the pursuit of dedicating oneself to the peace of mankind—these require an extensive educational period for our students to fully understand.
教员：但高尚的品德、对秩序的尊敬，以及为人类和平事业献身的崇高追求——这一切，需要用长久的教育来浇灌，才能让学生有所领悟。

Instructor: I believe the St. Pavlov Foundation put much thought into the decision that has allowed you to stand here.
教员：我相信圣洛夫基金会经过了慎重的决策，让你能够站在这里。

Instructor: You should feel honored.
教员：你该为此感到荣幸。

Erick: ...
埃里克：……

Instructor: Two distinguished graduates vouched for you and signed the 'Guardian Responsibility Treaty.'
教员：有两名优秀的毕业生为你担保，并签订了“责任监护人条约”。

Instructor: They didn't have to do this. It means that any rule violation on your part will directly impact their personal reputation.
教员：她们本可以不这样做，这意味着但凡你有任何违反校规的行为，都将直接影响到她们个人的声誉。

Instructor: So... think carefully about every word you're about to say. You're not just defending yourself...
教员：所以……好好想明白接下来你要说的每一句话。你不单单是在为自己辩护——

Erick: "Don't be selfish," "Think of others"... You grown-ups just love to bring others into everything; shift responsibility for everyone else onto our shoulders! I don't plan on defending anyone.
埃里克：“不要只顾自己”、“要为他人着想”……你们这些大人总喜欢把别人拎出来，让我们为别人负责。我才不打算辩护。

Erick: ...I'm willing to accept all the consequences.
埃里克：……我愿意承担这一切的后果。

Erick grabs the massive stone table. It begins to tremble, as if caught in an earthquake.
随着尘埃扑落，数吨重的石桌正在颤抖，宛如地动山摇一般。

Instructor: What are you doing?! Put the table down now!
教员：你在干什么?！快把桌子放下来！

Erick: ...I need to talk to Vertin.
埃里克：……我要跟维尔汀谈谈。

Instructor: You took off the arm ring—?
教员：臂环被脱下来了——?

Instructor: But they had already—
教员：但他们明明已经对你的臂环……

She glances at the girl's arm. The band mark is coiling around it like a red python.
她慌忙地望向女孩的手臂，箍痕像条红色的蟒蛇缠在上面。

"Bang!"
“砰!”

She hurls the stone table into the corner, and it shatters with a deafening crash.
石桌被丢到墙角，伴随着震耳欲聋的响动，分崩离析。

Erick: I need to ask her something important... I don't want to hurt you.
埃里克：我得问她一些重要的事……我不想伤害你。

Instructor: No, Erick... I'm afraid you need to calm down first.
教员：不，埃里克……恐怕你得先冷静下来。

Instructor: Security!
教员：安保人员!

"Bang! Bang! Bang!"
“砰！砰！砰!”

One by one, the staff members are hurled out of the office.
一个又一个壮实的职员被丢出办公室。

Guard I: Good heavens... This is far beyond our regular dealings. She's akin to a little lion!
安保人员 I：天呐……这可不适用普通的学校管理条例。她简直就是一头小狮子!

Guard II: We need to bring out the restraining equipment... Tell the logistics department to open the storage room!
安保人员 II： 我们得把那些制伏用器械都搬出来……让后勤部把库房的门打开！

Erick: I'm sorry... I really don't want to hurt you.
埃里克： 抱歉……我真的不想伤害你们。

Erick: Please, instructor, I just want to talk to her. After that... I'll accept any punishment.
埃里克： 拜托，教员，我只是想跟她聊聊，在这之后……无论什么惩罚我都愿意。

Instructor: ...
教员： ……

Meanwhile, rapid footsteps sound from afar.
与此同时，远处响起了急匆匆的脚步。

Before any message is relayed, two Foundation staff members arrive. It's as if they had foreseen the event.
消息还未传达，两位基金会职员却已犹如先知赶到。

Foundation Staff: Excuse me, instructor. You can leave now.
基金会职员： 抱歉，您可以先行离开了。

Foundation Staff: We'll take it from here.
基金会职员： 接下来将由我们接替您的工作。

Instructor: It appears you anticipated correctly.
教员： 看来，一切的事态都在你们的预料之内。

Instructor: Well, there's not much more I can do.
教员： 不过，我想我能做的确实已经不多了。

She heaves a sigh and leaves.
她叹息着，离去了。

Erick: ...
埃里克： ……

The corridor is silent again. All the students have returned to their dormitories.
楼道重归了寂静，学生们全都返回了宿舍。

Erick waits in her chair, trying to make out the muffled conversation taking place outside the office. A tall hat appears in the door frame.
她坐在椅子上，直到办公室外传来了交谈，一顶高帽子从门边露出。

Vertin: We can talk now.
维尔汀： 我们可以谈谈了。

Erick: Phew... Thank you for coming. Now I don't have to climb over the wall to find you.
埃里克： 呼……谢谢你的到来。现在我不用翻墙去找你了。

Vertin: Erick, this isn't what you promised us.
维尔汀： 埃里克，这跟你答应我们的不一样。

Erick: No, no, you need to answer me first.
埃里克： 不、不，你要先回答我。

She cuts her off with the sharpness of a knife.
她犹如一把小刀，毫不迟疑地切断话头。

Erick: Are you a smooth-talking liar like all the other grown-ups? Don't lie to me; I can see into your eyes...
埃里克：你是像其他大人一样油腔滑调的骗子吗？别撒谎，我看着你的眼睛呢……

Vertin: ...
维尔汀：……

Vertin: I don't think so.
维尔汀：我认为不是。

Erick: Good. Then please tell me—
埃里克：很好。那么请你告诉我——

She takes a deep breath before speaking.
她深吸一口气，才张开嘴。

Erick: What happened outside? Harald and the others... what really happened?
埃里克：外面发生了什么，哈拉尔他们……到底怎么了？

A familiar question, brought up yet again.
似曾相识的问题，重新被提起。

But times have changed, and nothing is as it once was.
可时过境迁，一切已不同于往日。

What's important is that a promise was made. And the truth needs to remain hidden now more than ever.
重要的是，一个承诺曾被应许。而真实比任何时刻都需要被隐藏。

Harald sits, carving a rough piece of wood with a hand knife.
他安坐在那儿，握住小刀，削着那块粗粝的木头块。

Despite his burly arms, his hands are incredibly gentle. The blade caresses the wood, carefully shaving off the excess.
和粗壮的手臂相比，他的手显得无比轻柔。利刃轻抚着木头，拂去多余的木料。

Only he knows that this body is fast losing its strength.
但只有他知道，这个躯体已快失去最后的气力。

Harald: Okay... now her little wooden sword has a home to return to.
哈拉尔：好了……这下，她那柄小木剑有家可回了。

He extends a bloodied hand, presenting a wooden sheath and a letter.
他伸出鲜血淋漓的手，将木头剑鞘递过去，连同信一起。

Vertin: What's this?
维尔汀：这是……

Harald: Some things I must say.
哈拉尔：一些必须由我来说的话。

In the distance, rugged figures have begun gathering.
而远处嶙峋的人影，正慢慢围拢上来。

Manus Monster I: *roars*
重塑·门徒 Ⅰ：ㄏㄡˇ——!

Manus Monster II: *roars*
重塑·门徒 Ⅱ：ㄏㄡˇ——!

They are like a tide, like a swarm of bees.
他们有如潮水，有如群蜂。

Harald: One, two, three...
哈拉尔：一、二、三……

He starts counting, but quickly gives up, shaking his head. Their number is far beyond that of the fingers on both hands.
他掰数着人影，摇摇头。指头不够用了。

He shifts his gaze back.
于是他把目光，重新挪移了回来。

Harald: You must do one last thing for me.
哈拉尔：你得最后帮我个忙。

Harald: Please... don't tell my dear child the truth about all this.
哈拉尔：请别……别告诉我的好孩子，关于这一切的真相。

His hand clutches the small wooden sheath, not yet ready to let it go.
他的手紧握着小小的剑鞘，还没打算松开。

Vertin: I can't stop this.
维尔汀：这不是我所能阻止的。

Harald: No, you must.
哈拉尔：不，你必须这样做。

This is not a plea.
这不是一个乞求。

In a flash, the bloodied tip of his knife is at Vertin's throat.
不知何时，他沾血的刀尖已经抵在了喉咙上。

Harald: I don't want to hurt you.
哈拉尔：我不想伤害你。

Vertin: You can't stop her from growing up.
维尔汀：我想你阻止不了她长大。

Harald: ...Child, trust me.
哈拉尔：……孩子，相信我。

Harald: When you reach my age, you'll understand that "growing up" is just a nice way of saying that people have to change—That we are forced to move forward.
哈拉尔：到了我这个年岁，你就会知道，“长大”这个说法，只是人们迫不得已，逼迫自己往前走的好听话。

Harald: She will make those steps on her own; I believe that more than anyone. But before that...
哈拉尔：她靠自己就会往前走的，我比你们任何人都相信这点。可在此之前……

Harald: Before that, I want her to wander a bit longer, see the sights, go where she pleases.
哈拉尔：在此之前，我想让她多瞎逛一会儿，走马观花，去哪儿都好。

Harald: To experience all that's bitter, sour, foul-smelling. To try everything with an open mind.
哈拉尔：把一切苦的、酸的、难闻的、呛人的，抱着好心吃一遍。

Harald: In the end, she'll come to understand on her own.
哈拉尔：到头来，她自己就会慢慢知道。

Harald: ...Promise me that you'll find a good place for her.
哈拉尔：……答应我，你会为她找一个好地方。

Vertin: Mm-hmm.
维尔汀：嗯。

Harald: You promise?
哈拉尔：你保证。

He retracts the knife from her neck and pulls off his bloodstained beast-cloak, revealing his arm ring. He removes it.
将刀收回手心。他撕下染血的兽衣，褪下了自己的臂环。

His hand trembles as he hands it over.
手颤抖着，他递了出去。

Vertin: ...
维尔汀：……

Vertin: I promise.
维尔汀：我保证。

Vertin: I promise, what's happening outside is an anomaly that you can't yet understand. Everyone has been afflicted with a serious illness.
维尔汀：我保证，外面只是出现了你现在还无法理解的异常。所有人都生了一场大病。

Vertin: But we will eventually find a way to resolve this disaster.
维尔汀：而我们终将找到解决这场灾难的方法。

Erick finally deflates her puffed chest.
她终于放松了昂起的胸脯。

Erick: ...A serious illness?
埃里克：……一场大病?

Erick: But what about those letters? There wasn't a word about that in any of them.
埃里克：可那些信，那些信是怎么回事？里面一句话也没提到过这件事。

Erick: Those replies... and the gifts... no, it doesn't make sense.
埃里克：那些回信……和礼物，不，这说不通。

She recalls what she saw last night.
昨晚所见，又在她脑海内重现。

Erick: You're not telling the truth... What else are you hiding from me? You never tell the truth, always covering one hole with another—
埃里克：你没有说实话……你还有什么东西瞒着我。你们从来不说实话，总是会用一个窟窿去填——

Her vision begins to blur.
眼前的人出现重影。

Something warm trickles from her nose. It smells ... metallic.
鼻腔有股热流涌出，那是……铁锈的味道。

Erick: Is this... blood?
埃里克：这是……血?

She gives a puzzled look at the drops of dark red liquid on her palm.
她疑惑地看着掌心的暗红色。

...
……

Vertin: Erick!
维尔汀：埃里克!

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

# 天真之诗
## The Song of Innocence AGD-06

The Song of Innocence
天真之诗

Laplace Rehabilitation Center
拉普拉斯康复中心

Mesmer Jr.: She's in a deep sleep. Unlike adults, who often relive traumatic memories during this time, children face the danger of never waking up from their dreams at all.
小梅斯梅尔：她现在处于深眠当中，与成年人入眠时普遍会唤起创伤记忆不同，孩童陷入梦境时，常会面临一去不醒的危险。

Vertin: Do we have a way to wake her up?
维尔汀：我们有唤醒的办法吗?

Mesmer Jr.: Was I not clear enough? This is a "condition," not an ordinary state of sleep. Forcibly waking her could cause serious brain trauma.
小梅斯梅尔：我说的不够明白是吗？这是种“病症”，而非正常的睡眠状态。强制唤醒会导致患者产生严重的脑内创伤。

Mesmer Jr.: Aside from letting her little brain wake up on its own, there is no other solution.
小梅斯梅尔：除了让她这个小脑瓜子自行苏醒，别无他法。

Mesmer Jr.: ...Such an out of control Arcanist ought to be subject to more stringent and regular checks.
小梅斯梅尔：……这样不可控的神秘学家，本应受到更严格的定期检测。

Mesmer Jr.: The LSCC's research on her grandfather's arm ring is still in the exploratory phase. It won't be of immediate help to her.
小梅斯梅尔：拉普拉斯科算中心对她外祖父的臂环的研究尚处于探索阶段，短时间内对她不会有所帮助。

Mesmer Jr.: Moreover, the death records here show that her mother was hospitalized for the same reason.
小梅斯梅尔：另外，这里的死亡病例显示，她的母亲曾因同样的病因入院。

Mesmer Jr.: This is the "gift" that accompanies their family's Arcanism, a rare kind of hereditary illness.
小梅斯梅尔：这是他们家族的神秘术所附带的“赠礼”，这样的家族遗传性病例可不算多见。

Mesmer Jr.: Fortunately, though, we have a sample right here with us now. This should prove useful in treating Arcanist illnesses.
小梅斯梅尔：不过，值得庆幸的，这样罕见的样本此刻就在这儿。这将为治疗神秘学家病患提供示范性的样本。

Mesmer Jr.: You have indeed made a good deal with her grandfather, Vertin.
小梅斯梅尔：你确实和她的外祖父达成了一桩不错的交易，维尔汀。

She presses a needle into Erick's wrist, and slowly releases the liquid within.
针刺入女孩的手腕，液体缓缓推进。

Mesmer Jr.: This is 5 milliliters of Mandragora extract, a hemostatic and neural blocker. It will slow the worsening of her condition to maintain her vital signs for about 2–3 days, but it's far greater than the normal dose.
小梅斯梅尔：这是 5 毫升的曼德拉草提纯液，止血兼神经阻滞的药物，能减缓病情恶化的进程，维持大概 2—3 天的生命体征，但也已经远远超出平常的剂量。

Mesmer Jr.: Even a carbuncle nearly 7 feet tall would be knocked unconscious by this. It's commonly used in the black market for live critter dissection.
小梅斯梅尔：就算是一头接近 7 英尺的卡邦克鲁也会昏迷不醒，这是黑市里常用作魔精活体解剖的药。

Vertin: But aren't we supposed to be finding a way to wake her up?
维尔汀：可我们不是要想办法唤醒她吗?

Mesmer Jr.: Aside from the coma, she has other, more lethal issues.
小梅斯梅尔：除了昏迷之外，她还有其他更致命的问题。

Mesmer Jr.: According to the blood dilution analysis report, her body is abnormally "expending" blood. Her veins are filled with blood-sucking parasites.
小梅斯梅尔：根据血液稀释分析报告，她那瘦小的身体正异常地“消耗”血液，血管里就像藏满了一堆吮血的寄生虫。

Mesmer Jr.: The most conservative treatment is to first calm these "parasites."
小梅斯梅尔：最为保守的治疗方式，是先让这群“寄生虫”冷静下来。

Mesmer Jr.: As I'm sure you know, this is our last sample.
小梅斯梅尔：你也很清楚，这是我们最后一个样本。

She returns the empty vial to the shelf.
空瓶罐放回了药架。

Mesmer Jr.: I'll come back in 4 hours.
小梅斯梅尔：4 小时后我会再回来一趟。

The medication quickly takes effect. Her breathing becomes lighter.
药物的作用很快，她的吐息变得轻缓。

Outside, dark clouds gather. They are building up to a downpour.
窗外阴云密布，一场大雨即将袭来。

...
……

The direct light is dazzling. Erick rubs her eyes. Her brain is on the verge of waking, but the sleepiness is unstoppable.
直照而下的光晃眼。她揉揉眼睛，大脑正濒临于苏醒边缘，而困倦却止也止不住。

Erick: @#&*￥@...
埃里克：@#&*￥@……

As she mutters incomprehensibly in her sleep, the softness of her blanket pulls her deeper into her dreams.
不明就里的梦呓，柔软的毯子引诱进入梦的更深处。

Her body instinctively rolls away from the light—
于是身体不由自主地避开光亮，向着另一侧翻滚——

"Thud!"
“咚！咚！”

Erick: Ouch! That hurts...
埃里克：嗷！疼疼疼……

Erick: Oww, my head! It's going to swell up as big as a bar of soap.
埃里克：呜呜，我的头！该肿起来肥皂那么大的包了。

Erick: Huh? Wait, this is...!
埃里克：嗯？等等，这里是……！

Erick: My room?!
埃里克：我的房间?!

The storybook lies open there on the floor.
翻开的故事书，仍懒趴趴地躺在地上。

The carpet is sticky with chewing gum, smelly socks crumpled on the ground. All the familiar messiness—
黏了口香糖的地毯，熟悉的臭袜子，熟悉的邋里邋遢——

Harald: My little sleepyhead, has winter finally passed?
哈拉尔：我的小懒虫，冬天终于走了是吗?

Erick: Harald?! Is this real?! Wait, I'll pull a hair to see if I'm dreaming...
埃里克：哈拉尔?！这是真的吗?！我要揪根腿毛，看看是不是在做梦……

Erick: Ouch... Ow! That really hurts!
埃里克：嘶……嗷！疼死我了！

Harald: Go wash your face quickly, and grab your helmet and weapons. Your dad's already gone to pick up your little sailors.
哈拉尔：快去冲把脸，别忘了把你的头盔和武器都戴上。你爸爸已经去载你的小船员了。

Erick: But, but why...
埃里克：可，可为什么……

Harald: Oh, have you forgotten? Today is the "Victory Party" I told you about. I'm so impressed that you've completed such a perilous journey. What a feat! I'm proud of you, child.
哈拉尔：噢，你忘了吗？我跟你说过的“凯旋派对”。你已经出色地完成了这趟危险的远行，一项伟大的壮举！真让人欣慰，孩子。

Erick: Right... that sounds familiar...
埃里克：好像是有那么一回事……

Harald: Looks like that fall really did a number on your head... We'll wait for you downstairs, child.
哈拉尔：看来刚才那下把你的脑袋摔得不轻……我们在楼下等你，孩子。

Harald: Remember to tidy up your room a bit.
哈拉尔：记得把屋子收拾收拾。

Erick: Okay, okay! You're starting to sound like nagging Old John!
埃里克：噢，知道啦！怎么跟老约翰一样唠叨……

She scratches her messy hair, opens the wardrobe, and starts rummaging around...
她挠着乱糟糟的头发，打开衣橱，开始翻翻找找……

Erick: But when did I get home...? I don't remember a thing.
埃里克：可是，我是什么时候回到家的……我怎么一点儿记忆也没有。

Erick: Where was I before—
埃里克：我原来，是待在哪儿——

Little Sailors: Welcome home, Erick!
一群小船员：欢迎回家，埃里克！

Erick: Oh! Sailors, you scared me!
埃里克：噢！船员们，你们吓了我一跳！

The children swarm around her, holding her hands, crowding her onto a throne draped with bearskin.
孩子们纷涌而来，牵着她的手，簇拥着她坐在披了熊皮的宝座上。

Snotty Buck: Erick, I heard you went to a place full of witches!
“鼻涕泡”布克：埃里克，我听说，你去了一个到处都是女巫的地方！

Jason “the Slob” : They could go anywhere unimpeded and could even predict exam questions! And they had monsters that could eat a tire whole in one bite.
“邋遢鬼”乔森：她们上天入地，还能预言考试测验！牵着的怪物一口就能吃掉一只轮胎。

Little Sailors: Is it true?! Is it true?!
一群小船员：这是真的吗?！这是真的吗?！

Erick: Calm down, sailors; it wasn’t as scary as that. Though it was certainly perilous, the witches there were actually quite reasonable...
埃里克：冷静点儿，船员们，那里没这么唬人。虽然确实危险得要命，但那里的女巫很讲道理……

Erick: And those monsters, wow, you have to see them to believe it. I can't even begin to describe how scary they looked.
埃里克：而那些怪物，哇，你们还得亲眼看看，我的嘴巴可描述不了它们那吓人的样子。

Little Sailors: Tell us, tell us!
一群小船员：快说说，快说说！

Erick: So, listen up, that place...
埃里克：那么听好了，那个地方……

A grand story begins anew, the children gasp in horror yet are unable to pull themselves away. They crane their necks like a little herd of giraffes.
一个伟大的故事再次开场，孩子们不时惊恐万分，却又止不住地聚精会神，把脸凑得像只长颈鹿。

Old John clatters in the kitchen, occasionally glancing at his daughter before going back to stirring his pot of thick soup.
老约翰在厨房乒呤乓啷，偶尔瞥上女儿一眼，又继续搅动锅里的浓汤。

Erick: There, I had two of the greatest sailors. They were...
埃里克：于是，在那里，我拥有了两名最了不起的船员。他们分别是……

Erick: They were...
埃里克：分别是……

The children continue to stare at her.
孩子们仍盯着她。

Erick: Sorry, it’s strange... I can't remember a thing.
埃里克：抱歉，真奇怪……我一点也不记得了。

As if a stone is suddenly lodged in her throat, she can no longer continue the story.
仿佛是有块石头突然堵在了嗓子眼，她再也无法让故事进行下去了。

???: Hey, Erick. Hey!
???：嘿，埃里克。嘿!

A voice seems to push through a thin membrane.
一个声音像是透过薄膜传过来。

Erick: Did you guys... hear something?
埃里克：你们……听见什么了吗?

Jason “the Slob” : Nope, I didn't hear anything.
“邋遢鬼”乔森：没有呀，我什么也没听见。

Snotty Buck: Heh-heh, I heard it! Jason, you bad boy, you ripped a stealthy one!
“鼻涕泡”布克：哼哼，我、我可是听见了！乔森，你这坏家伙，就是你偷偷放屁！

Jason “the Slob”: Y-You’re talking nonsense!
“邋遢鬼”乔森：你，你胡说！

They scrap it out, first Jason on top of Buck, then Buck targeting Jason’s ticklish spot.
他们缠在一起，先是乔森趴在布克身上，布克又挠起了他的咯吱窝。

They grab their desired pillows to start a pillow fight on the sofa.
饼干状、圆形状……他们挑选好最趁手的枕头，在沙发上开始厮杀。

The living room becomes a chaotic playground, with children cheering and laughing uproariously.
客厅里乱作一团，孩子们起哄着，捧腹大笑。

???: Pfft, pfft!
???：噗呲、噗呲！

???: Shh, don't bring "it" over here... be quiet, you idiot.
???：嘘，别把“它”招过来了……小声点儿，你这个笨蛋。

Two tiny figures press against the window, whispering.
两个小小的身影正紧紧贴在窗户边，窃窃私语。

But apart from Erick, no one else seems to notice them. She approaches the window and peers out.
可除了埃里克，似乎谁也没有发觉他们。她走上前，把脸凑了过去。

Erick: You two idiots, what are you doing standing there at my doorstep? Come in, all my friends are welcome!
埃里克：你们两个笨蛋，趴在我家门口做什么？快进来，我的派对欢迎所有朋友！

???: ...But w-we can't go in, Erick.
???：……可我、我们不能进去，埃里克。

???: "It" is coming...
???：“它”就要来了……

???: When "it" arrives, it takes away all joy. "It" will take away the candy and amusement parks, the fun of running away, and your prized little wooden sword.
???：等“它”来的时候，就会带走每一份喜悦。“它”会带走糖果和游乐园，带走逃跑时的欢喜，带走你引以为傲的小木剑。

???: "It" will eat your heart, so you'll never feel excitement again. Your feet will feel like they’re chained, and your head will feel like it’s carrying a hundred gold pieces, too heavy to lift again.
???：“它”会吃掉你的心，这样，你就再也不会因为什么东西感到雀跃了。你的脚会像上了锁链，你的头会像背着一百块金子一样，再也抬不起来。

???: Eventually, you'll start forgetting, forgetting the great stories and the treasures at your fingertips.
???：最后你就会开始遗忘，忘掉伟大的故事，还有唾手可得的宝藏。

???: We don't want that; we can't let "it" in.
???：我们可不想这样，我们不能让“它”进来。

Erick: Don't worry, guys, I'll knock "it" down before it can even take a breath!
埃里克：别担心，小伙子们，我一定会帮你们把“它”揍趴下，连口气也不会喘！

???: But it's our turn to protect you now, Jarl!
???：可是现在，该轮到我们保护你啦，领主！

???: Shh, shh! "It" is coming, run!
???：嘘嘘！“它”就要追过来了，快走！

The figures outside the window flee fast.
窗外的身影急匆匆地逃走了。

She quickly opens the window.
她连忙打开窗。

Erick: ...Strange, what's going on?
埃里克：……真奇怪，这是怎么回事?

The setting sun casts its rays, hitting her face and the green lawn outside. The sprinkler is hissing.
斜阳映在侧脸，翠绿色的草坪，喷水器滋滋作响。

But there's no one there.
可外面一个人也没有。

Harald: ...This is a frightening monster, child.
哈拉尔：……这个怪物很吓人，孩子。

Harald: I mean... yes, I do know of it.
哈拉尔：我是说……是的，我确实知道它。

Erick: What kind of monster is it? I didn't even see what it looks like...
埃里克：那是只什么怪物？我连它长什么样子都没见着……

Harald: Do you remember the museum ticket seller, the lady who always picked you up?
哈拉尔：还记得博物馆的售票员，总爱把你拎起来的那位女士吗?

Erick: Ms. Sigrid? Oh, her face was long and sour, her voice croaky like an old crow. If she caught you doing something she didn't like, you were in for a serious paddling.
埃里克：西格丽德女士？噢，她的脸又臭又长，声音哑得就像老乌鸦，要是被她抓住了，谁的屁股都少不了一顿蹂躏。

Erick: The worst part was having to listen to her endless lectures afterward. "Children should behave themselves." "When I was your age..." Blah, blah, blah. I'd rather walk the plank!
埃里克：最烦人的是，挨完揍还要听她说一大堆唠唠叨叨的话。什么“小孩子就得乖乖听话”、“像你们这么大的时候……”吧啦吧啦，天呐，还不如让我去走跳板!

Harald: Do you remember the day you climbed the "World Tree" and the carvings you found at the top?
哈拉尔：那么你还记得爬上“世界树”的那天，在树冠上发现的刻字吗?

Erick: *"The Eagle Feeder tops them all."*
埃里克：“‘喂鹰人’拔得头筹。”

Erick: *"The next kid to read these words will become the new master of the World Tree."*
埃里克：“下一位看到这些刻字的孩子，将成为世界树的新主人。”

Harald: It was Ms. Sigrid who carved those words.
哈拉尔：是西格丽德女士刻下了这些字。

Harald: When she was your age, she ran faster and jumped further than any boy in the village. But, none of the boys wanted to admit that a girl could best them.
哈拉尔：在她还像你这么大的时候，她就比镇子上所有男孩都跑得快，跳得远。可谁也不服气。

Harald: So, one day, they dared her to climb the World Tree, the tallest tree in the village. If she failed, then she would have to say they had been letting her win all along.
哈拉尔：于是有一天，他们合伙戏弄她，除非她爬上镇子上最高的世界树，否则，就得乖乖承认是男孩们故意让着她。

Harald: We all know what happened next.
哈拉尔：后来的结果，我们都知道了。

He sighs deeply, spreading his hands.
他长叹一口气，摊开了手。

Harald: But, adults always think a girl running fast or getting sun-tanned... is not a good thing.
哈拉尔：不过，大人们总归觉得女孩跑得太快，晒得太黑……不是什么好事情。

Harald: So, one day, the Eagle Feeder met this monster. At first, they were evenly matched, palm against claw, stubbornness against obstinacy.
哈拉尔：于是，终于有一天，喂鹰人撞上了那头怪物。他们先是针锋相对、势均力敌，一只手掌抵在另一只爪子上，一份倔强抵在另一份顽固上。

Harald: But eventually, she wore out.
哈拉尔：后来，她还是筋疲力尽了。

Harald: Her heart was torn to shreds by that monster, but no one ever saw her shed a tear.
哈拉尔：她的心儿被那头怪物撕得支离破碎，但始终没人见她掉过一滴眼泪。

Harald: —And then she became Ms. Sigrid, the gloomy ticket seller who's always telling off kids.
哈拉尔：——然后，她就成了西格丽德女士，成了那个垂头丧气的，总爱捉住你们的售票员。

Erick, sitting on the bed's edge, lowers her head uneasily.
坐在床沿的孩子，不安地垂下了头。

Erick: ...I'm so sorry for what I said about her. She was a courageous hero. That monster... must have been truly scary...
埃里克：……我真为对她的话感到抱歉，她是位有勇气的英雄。那个怪物，可当真可怕……

Harald: Yes. It has no name, and no one has ever seen it with their own eyes. You must be careful.
哈拉尔：是的，它没有名讳，亦没人见过它。你得当心，孩子。

Erick: But now, it's relentlessly pursuing my two sailors... They led the monster away to protect me.
埃里克：可现在，它对我那两位不知名的船员穷追不舍……他们为了保护我，把那怪物引到了别处。

Harald: They are brave too.
哈拉尔：他们同样是有勇气的人。

Erick: But what should I do? what should I do? Harald, can you help me?
埃里克：我该怎么办，可我该怎么办？哈拉尔，你能帮帮我吗?

She looks up eagerly, her eyes wide with hope.
孩子仰起头，渴盼地瞪大了眼睛。

Harald: I'm afraid not, child... My hands are too big, and the monster too small; my footsteps are too heavy, and its too light.
哈拉尔：恐怕不行，孩子……我的手太大，而它太过微小；我的脚步太重，而它太过轻盈。

Harald: Only a child could defeat it, and only a child could be defeated by it.
哈拉尔：只有孩子能够打败它，也只有孩子会被它打败。

Erick: But what if I lose to it? If I become like Ms. Sigrid... will you still love me the same?
埃里克：可如果抛下了你们，我输给它了呢？如果，我也变得和西格丽德女士一样……你还会那样爱我吗?

Harald: No matter what you become.
哈拉尔：不管你变成什么样。

He holds the child's arms until she stops trembling and raises her head.
他握住孩子的臂膀，直到她停止打颤，昂起了头。

It felt like she was gazing into his eyes a thousand, ten thousand times over.
犹如一千一万遍地注视着他的眼眸。

Harald: I'll be waiting for you.
哈拉尔：我在前面等你。

Her palms no longer tremble, her steps grow lighter.
她的手心不再颤抖，脚步愈发轻盈。

She runs down the hallway.
跑过冗长的走廊。

Runs down the stairs.
跑过层次分明的阶梯。

Runs through the bustling living room.
跑过熙来攘往的客厅。

Jason "the Slob": Erick, where are you going? Are you leaving the party?
"邋遢鬼"乔森：你要去哪儿，埃里克？你要离开派对吗？

Snotty Buck: You can't go, we've been waiting ages for you. Look, we even brought a popcorn machine from the shop!
"鼻涕泡"布克：你可不能走，我们可等了你好久好久。瞧，我们还去商店专门搬来了爆米花机！

Little Sailors: We want to hear your stories about your grand adventure, about the treasures you brought back!
一群小船员：我们还有好多故事想听呢，关于你的伟大冒险，关于你带回来的那些财宝！

Erick: Sorry...
埃里克：抱歉……

Erick: I miss you all and those good old days of adventuring...
埃里克：我很想念你们，也非常想念那些咱们一起打家劫舍的好日子……

Erick: But I've made a promise to two other sailors you don't know. I can't abandon them...
埃里克：但我已经与另外两位你们还没见过的船员，许下了承诺。我不能抛弃他们……

Erick: Sailors, I'll come back for you, but not now.
埃里克：船员们，我会回来找你们，但不是现在。

Erick: Jason, sorry... I'll return your homework later. You can blame it on me.
埃里克：乔森，抱歉……你的作业我得迟一点还你。让老师把这账记在我头上。

Jason "the Slob": ...Don't worry, boss. My behind is battle-hardened. Even if the teacher comes with a branding iron, I won't utter a sound!
"邋遢鬼"乔森：……放心，头儿。我的屁股已经身经百战。老师就算拿烙铁过来，我也不会吱一声！

Erick: And Buck, if Nasty Abel still bothers you while I'm gone... tell him to stop acting smug; Jarl Erick will settle the score.
埃里克：至于布克，我不在的时候，如果"恶棍亚伯"还来欺负你……告诉他别得意，埃里克领主会把账都算回来的。

Erick: If he wants more trouble, take Jason's hellhound "Garm" over there.
埃里克：如果他还想吃苦头，就去把乔森家的冥犬"嘉尔姆"带过去。

Erick: Remember, it only eats sturgeon fish that have been left out for three days and three nights.
埃里克：记住，它只爱吃放了三天三夜的臭鲟鱼。

Snotty Buck: Thank you...
"鼻涕泡"布克：谢谢……

The children watch her, like a farewell choir.
孩子们注视着她，宛如一个送别的合唱团。

She grabs the doorknob, feeling the cold metal in her palm.
她握住门把手，金属的冰冷沾上手掌。

Suddenly, a hand reaches out to stop her.
突然，一只手上前阻止了她。

Erick: Old John... don't block the way, this isn't—
埃里克：老约翰……别挡道，这可不是——

—He wraps both hands around her shoulders.
——两只手挽住了她的脖子。

He ruffles her golden hair. His embrace makes it hard for her to breathe.
他揉搓她的金发，硬邦邦的警服让她喘不过气。

But she doesn't resist, she just allows him to hold her tightly, so tightly.
但她没打算阻止，只是允许他就这样紧紧地、紧紧地抱着。

Eventually, he lets go.
他还是松手了。

Erick: I have to go.
埃里克：我该走了。

She turns the doorknob.
她转动门把手。

The dawn light spills through the gaps in the trees, illuminating her in patterns.
曙光穿过树梢的罅隙，泼洒到身上。

Erick: Goodbye, Dad.
埃里克：再见，爸爸。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

# 梦醒时分
## Awakening Hours AGD-07

The Waking Moment
梦醒时分

Erick: ...
埃里克：……

Sonetto: Erick?!
十四行诗：埃里克?!

Mesmer Jr.: 6 minutes and 37 seconds. Consistent with the awakening trend on the monitoring device.
小梅斯梅尔：6 分 37 秒，与监测仪所表现出来的苏醒趋势一致。

She jots down several notes in the medical record book.
她在病历记录本上划上几道。

Mesmer Jr.: Lie back down and don't move. I'll get the medicine.
小梅斯梅尔：躺好了，别动。我去拿药。

They are left alone in the hospital room.
病房中再次只剩下她们。

...
……

Sonetto: You've been unconscious for days... They thought you would never wake up.
十四行诗：你连续昏迷了很多天……他们一度以为你醒不过来了。

Erick: Cough, cough... I was planning to visit Valhalla.
埃里克：咳、咳……我是打算去一趟英灵殿。

Erick: But Harald and those stinky old lice-ridden men grabbed my ears and said it wasn't my time yet.
埃里克：可哈拉尔和那群长着虱子、臭烘烘的老头们，揪住我的耳朵，说什么还没到时候。

Erick: That's a bit—
埃里克：这也太小——

Sonetto lays her hand on Erick's.
一只手覆了上来。

Sonetto: ...Erick, I'm sorry.
十四行诗：……埃里克，我很抱歉。

Sonetto: Those letters... they weren't actually written by Harald—
十四行诗：那些信，其实并不是哈拉尔亲手写的——

She freezes, then gently shakes her head.
她怔住了，而后却轻轻摇了摇头。

Erick: I understand.
埃里克：我明白。

Erick: Thank you for being honest, and for all you've done for me.
埃里克：谢谢你的坦白，也谢谢你一直为我……做这些。

There is no longer doubt in her eyes.
她的眼眸已不再怀疑。

Erick: How are those grown-ups I injured? I... didn't mean to toss them so hard.
埃里克：那些受伤的大人还好吗？我……没想到会把他们丢那么高。

Erick: They won't let me go back, will they?
埃里克：恐怕他们不会再让我回去了，对吗？

Sonetto: Well...
十四行诗：嗯……

Sonetto: The SPDM's management committee has submitted your transfer application...
十四行诗：第一防线学校管理委员会已提交你的转校申请……

???: **What—?!**
???: **什——么?!**

The bed frame begins to shake violently.
床架忽然一阵剧烈晃动。

Two dusty little heads pop out from under the bed.
两个沾满灰尘的小脑袋，打从床底冒了出来。

Erick: Hey, what are you two doing here?
埃里克：嘿，你们怎么都在这儿？

Sonetto: I asked the instructor to bring them here. I thought it might help your condition...
十四行诗：是我向教员申请，将他们带过来，我想这对你的病情或许会有所帮助……

But no one is paying any attention to her response.
但她的回答抛出来，谁也顾不上接。

Golden Key Sancho: Boss, you can't drop out!
金钥匙桑丘：头儿，你可绝不能退学！

Golden Key Sancho: I—I, I can bring out my precious Sharpodonty collection! The book I read said that staff and instructors always fall for that...
金钥匙桑丘：我——我，我可以把我珍藏的利齿子儿都拿出来！那些书里说，官员和老师最吃这一套了……

Erick: ...Sancho, don't.
埃里克：……桑丘，别。

Erick: Your critter has been waiting in Ms. NewBabel's cage for so long...
埃里克：你的魔精在新巴别塔橱笼里等了那么久……

Erick: Besides—(cough, cough...)
埃里克：再说——咳、咳……

She hunches over, covering her mouth as if choking on thick smoke.
她佝偻着捂住嘴，像呛了一口浓烟。

Sancho opens his mouth to speak, but he can't say a word.
桑丘才张开嘴，可这下子，他一句话也说不出来了。

Her coughing... is like a small wooden hammer pounding on their hearts.
她的咳嗽声，一下，又一下……像是一柄小木槌，捶在他们的心头上。

Effie: Really... there's no hope left?
埃菲：真的……一点儿余地都没有了吗?

Sonetto: Sorry...
十四行诗：抱歉……

Effie: ...If you leave, I'll never talk to anyone else ever again.
埃菲：……要是你走了，我就再也不和其他人说话了。

Effie: (Sob...) I thought I finally found a real friend... but it turns out all this effort was for nothing.
埃菲：呜……我还以为我找到真朋友了呢……可、可费了这么大劲儿，一点儿意义都没有。

Effie: I knew it would end like this, yet I still planned so much with you...
埃菲：我明明知道结果会这样，却还是和你一起计划了那么多的事……

Effie: "People delude themselves into passion in life, painting a portrait of themselves; but in the end, they are left with nothing but the portrait."
埃菲：“人们一厢情愿地投入生活，为自己画像；但最后，除了这幅画像，他们一无所有。”

Effie: They were right... (Sob)
埃菲：他们说的一点儿也不错……呜。

She lowers her head, her shoulders shaking. She wipes the tears and snot from her face.
她低下头，肩膀颤抖，手腕擦抹着脸上的涕泪。

Golden Key Sancho: Don't be like this, Eifer... The boss is hurting too.
金钥匙桑丘：别这样，埃菲……头儿也不好受。

Effie: (Sob...) No, she isn't; if you ask me, we've all been deceived.
埃菲：呜呜……她才没有，要我说，咱们都被骗了。

Effie: What about the mountains of treasures? The monsters called "Emptiness" and "Vanity"? There's no such thing anywhere in the world.
埃菲：什么一座山高的财宝呀，什么名叫“虚无”、“虚荣”的怪物呀，世界上根本就没有这些东西。

Effie: If there were, you would have taken us to see it for ourselves!
埃菲：如果真的有，你倒是亲自带我们去看一眼呀……！

Erick: ...
埃里克：……

Effie: You're so reckless, always getting us into trouble. Because of you, my semester badge got revoked.
埃菲：你吊儿郎当，还老让我们陪你闯祸。因为你，我的学期奖章都被教员撤销了。

Effie: You don't actually have a ship or any of those thrilling adventures. You just have a silly little wooden sword!
埃菲：你其实根本就没有长船，也没有经历那些惊心动魄的冒险，只有一柄傻乎乎的小木剑！

Effie: (Sob...) And what can you command with it? What can you cut with it?
埃菲：呜……而它又能号令谁呢，它又能砍断什么呢？

She covers her eyes with her arms, but the tears keep falling and the snot keeps dripping.
她的手臂遮住眼睛，鼻涕和眼泪却一直往下掉。

"Drip, drip—"
“吧嗒吧嗒——”

Effie: I knew it all, everything—
埃菲：我什么都知道，什么都知道——

Effie: Even so, we still followed you around.
埃菲：哪怕这样子，我们还是屁颠屁颠跟在你后面。

Effie: But now, you don't care about us anymore (sob sob sob...)
埃菲：可现在，你却管也不管我们，呜呜呜……

Golden Key Sancho: The boss hasn't abandoned us—
金钥匙桑丘：头儿没有不管我们——

She pushes away the tissue presented in Sancho's hand.
She doesn't even glimpse at Erick.
她推开递来纸巾的手。
看也没看床上的孩子一眼。

She runs off like a child soaked by the rain.
就像淋了雨的孩子，她又远又轻地跑了。

Golden Key Sancho: Hey, hey, Eifer—!
金钥匙桑丘：嘿、嘿，埃菲——！

Erick: Sorry...
埃里克：对不起……

Golden Key Sancho: It's okay, boss... It's not your fault.
金钥匙桑丘：没关系，头儿……这不是你的错。

A nurse pushes in a medicine cart, followed by a familiar hat.
护士推着医药架走了进来，后面跟随着熟悉的帽子。

Golden Key Sancho: Look... I have to go too.
金钥匙桑丘：瞧……我也得走了。

Golden Key Sancho: Get well soon, boss.
金钥匙桑丘：好好养伤，头儿。

Erick: (Cough, cough, cough)
埃里克：咳、咳、咳——

Erick: Wait...!
埃里克：等等……！

He too leaves.
这下，连他也走了。

...
……

Mesmer Jr.: Put out your hand.
小梅斯梅尔： 把手伸出来。

Mesmer Jr.: Take a deep breath.
小梅斯梅尔： 深呼吸。

Mesmer Jr.: There will be momentary pain in your wrist, but after 1 minute and 28 seconds, your arm will be completely numb.
小梅斯梅尔： 手腕上会有一瞬间的阵痛，1 分钟 28 秒后，你的手臂只会留下麻痹感。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

# 跃往明日
## A Leap Into the Future AGD-08

A Leap Into the Future
跃往明日

"Pirates flee in terror. Children hold conches filled with honey and milk."
“海盗落荒而逃。孩子们高举海螺，那盛满蜂蜜与奶的水。”

"They fall asleep in groups on the damp deck."
“他们在湿漉漉的甲板上，群群入眠。”

"But on the other side, the adults weep, and the light of the lamp by the bed shines into their dreams."
“可在那彼岸，大人们流着泪，在床枕边所点燃的灯火，也照进了他们的梦。”

"So when dawn comes, the first child returns home."
“于是当黎明到来，第一个孩子归家了。”

Letter: Harald... this is my last day at the SPDM.
信纸： 哈拉尔……这是我在第一防线学校的最后一天。

Letter: ~~Harald... this is my last day at the SPDM.~~
信纸： ~~哈拉尔……这是我在第一防线学校的最后一天。~~

Letter: Harald, I had a good time here...
信纸： 哈拉尔，我在这里过得——

Letter: ~~Harald, I had a good time here...~~
信纸： ~~哈拉尔，我在这里过得——~~

Letter: Harald... If you can't see these letters, then what's the point of me writing them?
信纸： 哈拉尔……如果你不能看到这些信的话，我写的这一切又还有什么意义呢?

Erick: ...
埃里克： ……

She leans back in her chair and stares at the ceiling with a vacant gaze.
她靠在椅子上，两眼空空，仰望着天花板。

Neither in pain nor weary, yet heavy in every way.
既不疼痛，亦不劳瘁，却千般、万般沉重。

What is that? What is that...?
那是什么？那是什么……？

???: Pfft, pfft!
???: 噗呲、噗呲！

Erick: Huh?!
埃里克: 嗷?！

A head pops into view.
一个脑瓜蹦儿弹到了脑门上。

Golden Key Sancho: Hehe~ surprise attack successful!
金钥匙桑丘: 嘿嘿～偷袭成功！

Erick: San...cho? What are you doing here? Haven't you got Critter Training Class today?
埃里克: 桑……丘？你怎么在这儿，今天不是要上“魔精驯服课”吗?

Golden Key Sancho: Forget about class.
It's been boring since you stopped attending.
金钥匙桑丘: 别管那堂课了。
自从你停课以后，那堂课就没劲儿死了。

Golden Key Sancho: I thought I'd come to see you off, boss.
金钥匙桑丘: 我还不如来送送你～头儿。

Golden Key Sancho: I had a hard time finding your dorm. With all those winding corridors, I almost got lost.
金钥匙桑丘: 我可费了好大劲儿才找到你的宿舍，弯弯绕绕的，都快把我绕迷糊了。

Golden Key Sancho: Wow, your room is so much bigger than mine. I'm jealous.
金钥匙桑丘: 喔，你的房间可比我们的大太多了。旁听生可真让人羡慕。

He looks around. The once scattered books are now neatly piled in the corner.
他环顾四周，七零八落的书本，整齐地堆垒在角落中。

All that mess, those cherished things, are now packed into boxes.
所有的凌乱，所有随意却珍视的一切，如今都被放进了小小的箱子。

It's as if they were never there.
就像从未来过。

And suddenly, the weight of reality makes his heart tremble.
于是乎，那股沉甸甸的，一下也令他心头颤抖了。

Golden Key Sancho: I didn't know... you packed up so quickly.
金钥匙桑丘: 我不知道……你收拾得这么快。

Golden Key Sancho: You're... leaving already?
金钥匙桑丘: 你……马上就要走了吗?

???: .....!
???: ……！

The feet behind the door have become restless.
门背后的双脚，终于也按捺不住。

Effie: ...
埃菲: ……

Golden Key Sancho: Hey! Eifer, didn't we agree that I'd go first—?
金钥匙桑丘：嘿！埃菲，咱们不是说好，我先——

Effie: We still have a secret plan to carry out!
埃菲：我们还有一个秘密计划没实行完呢！

Effie: You! Deserter with the rolled up bedding!
埃菲：你这个卷包袱的逃兵！

She points her finger like a judge scoffing at a criminal.
她举着手指，就像一位对罪人嗤之以鼻的法官。

Erick: What?! I didn't run away!
埃里克：什么?！我可没有逃跑！

Erick leaps up from her chair.
我们的英雄一下子从椅子上跳了起来。

Effie: A scurrying thief, a traitor who drops his weapon, a stupid... pirate!
埃菲：鼠窜的窃贼，丢武器的叛徒，缺心眼的……海盗！

Erick: Hey, hey! If you had stopped at the first two, we could still be friends, but that last one...
埃里克：嘿、嘿！如果你只说前两个，咱们还能做朋友，但最后一个……

Erick: We're going to have to part ways, you... crybaby!
埃里克：咱们得分道扬镳了，你这个……爱哭精！

Effie: Humph, if you've got the guts, come with us!
埃菲：哼，你要是有胆子，倒是跟我们一块儿来！

Effie: But, I guess you wouldn't dare! You just can't wait to go running back to your grandfather.
埃菲：不过，我猜你根本就不敢！你正着急着回家找外公呢。

Effie: "Waaah—Harald, I miss you so much, waaah, waaah waaah!"
埃菲：“呜呜呜——哈拉尔我好想你噢，呜呜呜呜呜～”

Effie: Let's go, Sancho.
埃菲：咱们走，桑丘。

She runs to the door and makes a big funny face.
她跑到门口，做了一个大大的鬼脸。

Erick: Uh—ah! Just you wait!
埃里克：呃——啊！咱们走着瞧！

She tosses aside her chair and charges down the hallway.
她丢下一切，向着走廊，纵身冲去。

She pushes open the door, pushes past the white robes, pushes past the gaze of the children.
她拨开门扇，拨开白袍子，拨开孩子们的目光。

Pushes past the curtains that fell of their own accord.
拨开，自顾自落下的帷幕。

Pushes past the endless persuasion of the adults—
拨开，大人层出不穷的劝服——

Letter: “Dear Harald,”
信纸：致亲爱的哈拉尔——

Letter: “This is my last day at the SPDM.”
信纸：这是我在第一防线学校的最后一天。

Letter: “I feel more uneasy than ever, as if lost in an endless night.”
信纸： 我比任何时候都感到不安，就像走丢在了茫茫黑夜里。

Letter: “I'm really scared, terribly so.”
信纸： 我真害怕，害怕得不得了。

Effie: Shh... the instructor has gone to bed. We need to be quieter.
埃菲： 嘘……教员休息去了，咱们得动静儿小一点。

Golden Key Sancho: Come out, come out, don't be afraid. The boss doesn't bite.
金钥匙桑丘： 出来、出来，别害怕。我们的头儿不咬魔精。

He opens the cage, and the glavakus sniffs his hand, hesitating.
他打开栅笼，格拉瓦库斯嗅了嗅他的手，踌躇不前。

Letter: “I think I met that monster you told me about, but I couldn't defeat it.”
信纸： 我想我遇到那个怪物了，但我没能打败它。

Letter: “Of course, it hasn't defeated me, either.”
信纸： 当然，它也还没打败我。

Golden Key Sancho: Good job, good boy, that's it. Come meet our boss.
金钥匙桑丘： 好样的，好孩子，就是这样。来见见我们的头儿。

Glawackus: Aroo...?
格拉瓦库斯： 嗷……?

It looks up innocently.
它无辜地仰起头。

Golden Key Sancho: Now, lie down, let our boss sit on you.
金钥匙桑丘： 现在，趴下来，让我们的头儿坐上去。

Glawackus: #&%￥!
格拉瓦库斯： #&%￥!

It opens its mouth and bites her cape.
它张开嘴，又把她的披风含进了嘴里。

Erick: ...
埃里克： ……

Letter: “But I've recognized its form.”
信纸： 但我已经认出了它的模样。

Letter: “Just as it recognized me—”
信纸： 就像它也认出了我一样——

Letter: “They say every child has to face some hardship to realize their own form. To end up where they ought to be.”
信纸： 他们说，每个孩子都会吃些苦头，认清自己的模样，最后呆在该呆的地方。

Letter: “They say every ambitious ship crew eventually runs out of food and sneaks back to the old harbor on a quiet night.”
信纸： 他们说，每艘雄心勃勃的巨船终归会花光食粮，最后在一个悄无声息的夜里逃回旧港。

Letter: “So I guess I've always been scared, scared like a cornered squirrel.”
信纸： 所以我想我一直很害怕，害怕得像是一只角落里的松鼠。

Letter: “I'm afraid of the endless nights without you, that I'll lose all my courage and run away.”
信纸： 我害怕没有你的无穷黑夜，自己会失掉所有的勇气，落荒而逃。

Letter: “I'm afraid that the grown-ups are right, and the children are wrong.”
信纸：我害怕大人说的是对的，而孩子们是错的。

Letter: “That all this is just a child's fantasy.”
信纸：这一切不过是孩子在卧室的幻想。

Letter: “That heroes and treasures no longer exist in this world.”
信纸：这世界上已不再存有英雄与宝藏。

Letter: ...
信纸：……

Letter: “But they do exist, Harald.”
信纸：可他们存在。哈拉尔。

Letter: “My little wooden sword was never sharp.”
信纸：我的小木剑从不锋利。

Letter: “And my ship would be easily overturned by a small wave.”
信纸：而我的长船，恐怕连一阵小浪花都能掀翻。

Letter: “But I'd rather be swallowed by a wave than sit at home on a sofa.”
信纸：但我宁愿一股大浪吞掉我，也不愿坐在软塌塌的沙发上。

Letter: “I'd rather perish and be immortalized in the epics of a minstrel than idly daydream of futures that will never come—”
信纸：但我宁愿永逝在吟游诗人的传唱中，也不愿日复一日怀抱着从未到来的美梦——

Letter: “I won’t wait for a predetermined fate to take me.”
信纸：去等待着既定的命运。

Letter: “Besides, my sailors look to me for guidance.”
信纸：况且，我的船员，等得那样焦急。

Golden Key Sancho: It—it, lowered its head, boss!!!
金钥匙桑丘：它、它，把头低下来了，头儿！！！

Effie: Now's the chance!
埃菲：趁现在！

Glawackus: ...?
格拉瓦库斯：……？

Erick: Now!
埃里克：就是现在！

Erick: Hehe, looks like the canned food we hid for you worked.
埃里克：哼哼～看来咱们为你藏的罐头还是有点儿作用。

Erick: Come, my ravenous friend.
埃里克：来呀，我嗜血如麻的朋友。

Erick: Forward, swallow the gold, swallow the test papers, swallow the teaching sticks!
埃里克：往前，吞掉黄金，吞掉试卷，吞掉教鞭！

Matilda: Hey! What are you doing? Get off that glavakus!
玛蒂尔达：嘿！你们在做什么？我命令你们快从格拉瓦库斯身上下来！

Golden Key Sancho & Effie: Run!
金钥匙桑丘&埃菲：快跑！

Letter: “The crew will eventually part ways. The banquet will fall silent.”
信纸：即便所有船员终将别离，而宴席也归于寂静。

Letter: “In the end, everything is in vain.”
信纸： 万般都是徒劳。

Letter: “Nothing will remain.”
信纸： 什么也不会留下。

Erick: Ha-ha-ha-ha!
埃里克： 哈哈哈哈哈！

The "Great" Storyteller: But I’ll tell you—those who defy make the journey worthwhile.
“伟大”讲述者： 但我要告诉你——不顾一切的人才不虚此行。

This story is dedicated to
the daydreamers
and those whose souls are free from the restrictions of their body.
献予
爱唤白日梦的孩子
及那些身在而心不在的灵魂

*The Three Musketeers*
《三个火枪手》

*Who Is "Madam Ghost?"*
《“幽灵女士”大揭秘》

英文 / ENGLISH

Erick the Fleet-Footed
中文 / CHINESE

《轻松赢取赛跑比赛的领主》

*-THE END-*
-THE END-

Visitors, doctors... everyone has gone.
访客、医生……人们已悉数离去。

The room sits in perfect silence.
这是恰好的寂静。

Vertin: Erick, I'm sorry. You know our agreement.
维尔汀： 埃里克，抱歉，你知道我们的约定。

Vertin: Due to this incident, you'll be transferred to the School of Corrections until they determine you have sufficient self-control and common sense...
维尔汀：由于这起意外，你必须得转学去教管学校。直到他们评定你拥有了足够的自控能力与常识水平……

The child doesn't resist, emitting a consenting hum.
孩子并未抗拒，发出了应许的鼻音。

Vertin: But first, I think...
维尔汀：在此之前，我想……

Vertin: You should know the truth about what's happening outside.
维尔汀：你应该知道发生在外面的真相。

Erick: Mm-hmm, I'm ready.
埃里克：嗯，我准备好了。

She immediately shakes her head.
她旋即又摇了摇头。

Erick: But I want to see it for myself.
埃里克：不过，我要自己亲自去看。

She looks out the window, turning her gaze to the stormy sky.
她眺向窗外。

THE END
THE END